

FINAL REPORT

**Nineteenth
Annual Meeting
of the
General Service
Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous**

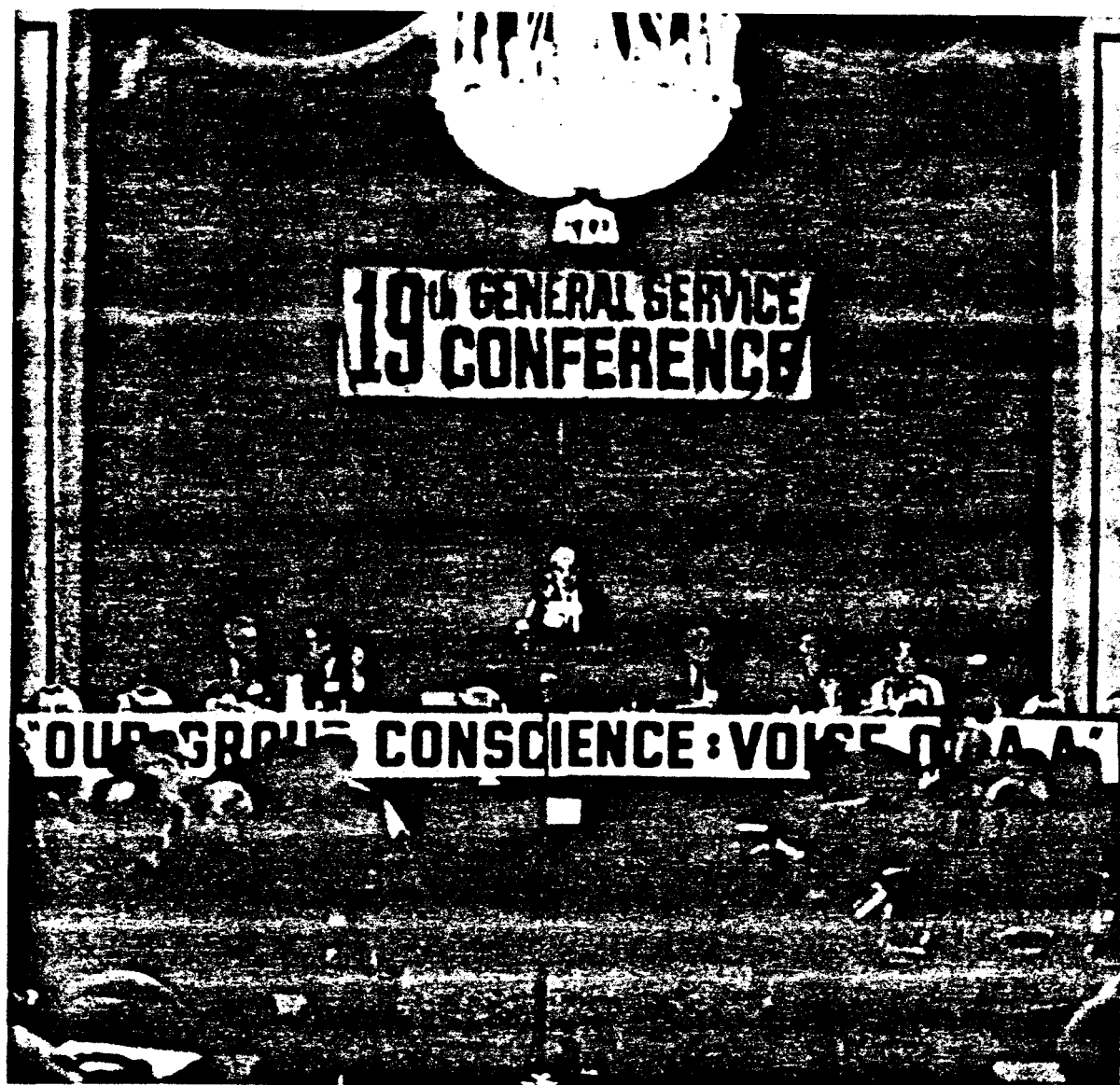
**Roosevelt Hotel
New York
April 21-26, 1969**



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An A.A. member may order a copy of this report through his G.S.R. or other group officer. Traditionally, all members have the right of access to information about all phases of A.A.'s General Services. This report is "confidential" only because in it certain members must be identified by name. The "confidential" designation protects the personal anonymity of such members at the public level.

\$1.75 per copy



"Our Group Conscience: Voice of A. A."

— CONFERENCE THEME

Excerpts from THE CONFERENCE CHARTER

1. *Purpose:* The General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the world services and of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous.



2. *Composition:* The Conference (North American Section) shall be composed of area delegates, the trustees of the General Service Board, directors of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, the surviving co-founder of A.A., staff members of the Grapevine and General Service Office, and foreign delegates as the Conference may wish to invite.



3. *Conference Relation to A.A.:* The Conference will act for A.A. in the perpetuation and guidance of its world services, and it will also be the vehicle by which the A.A. movement can express its views upon all matters of vital A.A. policy and all hazardous deviations from A.A. Tradition. Delegates should be free to vote as their conscience dictates; they should also be free to decide what questions should be taken to the group level, whether for information, discussion or their own direct instruction.
4. *Conference Relation to the General Service Board and its Corporate Services:* The Conference will replace the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous who formerly functioned as guides and advisers to the General Service Board and its related service corporations. The Conference will be expected to afford a reliable cross section of A.A. opinion for this purpose.

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Conference at a Glance

Group Conscience Guides A.A.

A.A. is in excellent shape as seen from the vantage point of the Board of Trustees and as reflected in its actions during the past year, Dr. John L. Norris, chairman, told delegates to the 19th General Service Conference.

Citing a number of policies established and problems solved during the past year, Dr. Jack said that the one major concern still facing the Board and the Fellowship as a whole was the fact that group contributions are still substantially below the cost of group services.

Noting that it is unity which "assures our future," Dr. Jack said that it sometimes seems that we concentrate too much on the "now," thinking too often of A.A. as "ours" when perhaps we should remember more frequently that it is "theirs" too. "For 'they' are the legions of alcoholics yet to come."

"We must all remember that A.A. is ours to give away—to pass on—and that unless we do, we lose it. Other generations will need A.A. as we need it now. Other people, other kinds of people whom we are not reaching, need it now. So with the help of God, we must pass our Fellowship along, unimpaired and indivisible.

Pointing out that delegates to the Conference represented the group conscience of A.A. in North America, Dr. Norris said that as long as our real concern was for all of A.A. rather than for personal or purely local desires, our decisions will be right and A.A.'s future bright."

In the final talk of the Conference, Bernard B. Smith, a nonalcoholic trustee, spoke on the theme of the Group Conscience. "It was very early in the history of these Conferences that we became profoundly aware of the underlying strength of the power of the principles that guide us to the right and away from the wrong," he said.

Delegates Discuss New Policies

New York, April 26 – Delegates representing the group conscience of A.A. members throughout the United States and Canada acted to provide new and improved services to members in virtually all areas of A.A. activity during the 19th General Service Conference which concluded here today.

Working through a five and one-half day series of almost continuous meetings at the Roosevelt Hotel, Delegates sought better ways of carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics who still suffer throughout the world.

Ninety delegates, elected by groups from every state and province, together with alcoholic and nonalcoholic General Service Board trustees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors and staff members form the 128-member Conference. They act on behalf of the Fellowship to provide guidance to the Board, G.S.O. and Grapevine. Some Conference highlights:

PUBLIC INFORMATION – Reviewed new color TV public service announcement being made available to groups.

AL-ANON – Recognized special relationship with Al-Anon Family Groups and acknowledged debt of gratitude for assistance to families of alcoholics.

GRAPEVINE – Recommended that A.A. World Services and the A.A. Grapevine extend to each other the fullest cooperation in making the Fellowship aware of A.A. tools.

1970 CONVENTION – Approved progress being made on 35th Anniversary Convention, Miami Beach, July 3-5, 1970.

WORLD SERVICE MEETING – Elected Warren S., Southern Coastal, Calif., and Charles D., Central Mich., as North American delegates to first A.A. World Service Meeting in October.

G.S. BOARD – Elected Bill C., Northeastern, and John R., Western Canada, as regional trustees.

INSTITUTIONS – Recommended that A.A. membership be restricted to admitted alcoholics, but that groups in institutions welcome narcotics addicts and others to inside open meetings, provided that they do not speak or otherwise participate.

LITERATURE – Approved final draft of the A.A. Service Manual and recommended that Institutions Directories be distributed every two years with yearly supplements.

POLICY – Approved resolution to avoid participation on radio or TV programs unless given adequate time for preparation, or unless it serves an A.A. objective, or the primary discussion is appropriate to A.A., and anonymity is guaranteed.

NEW A.A. SIZE

Spring 1969

	Groups	Members
United States	8,595	148,424
Lone Members . . .		150
Canada	1,556	21,629
Lone Members . . .		47
In Hospitals	648	18,548
In Prisons	891	33,775
Internationalists . .		344
	11,690	222,917
Overseas*	3,057	60,412
Totals.	14,747	283,329

*Estimated only, until Part II of the *World Directory* is published in August 1969.

(Including non-reported members, actual membership is estimated at more than 425,000 worldwide.)

Lois Shares Memories of A.A.'s Early Days

The regular A.A. meeting, traditional highlight of the opening dinner, was led this year by Don W., Panel 18, Western Michigan, with fellow speakers also from Panel 18—Wyn D., Western Ontario and Charlie D., Arizona.

On hand to greet delegates were Bill and Lois. This year Lois spoke of A.A.'s early days:

LOIS W.:

"As you know, A.A. started in Akron in 1935. But there wasn't any literature until 1939, so in all that time the A.A. story had to be carried by word of mouth from one alcoholic to another. There was a lot of traveling about: it was an accepted fact that whoever had a car picked up everyone else and off we'd go to a meeting; it didn't matter if it was in the next town or not.

"There was a real communal spirit among us, a sharing of everything you had with the other fellow. Those who had homes opened them to anybody who needed a place to sleep, to any other A.A. or prospect. Our house in Brooklyn, too, was constantly full of drunks—from the top floor to the basement. Some of them stayed sober, but unfortunately a lot of them stayed drunk, and did all kinds of remarkable things — very remarkable things!

'All Told, a Marvelous Experience'

"I remember that one of them got hold of a big carving knife and chased another man all around the house, down the cellar, up the stairs, until a third man grabbed the knife. There was a little fat man who stayed in the basement and who did quite interesting things. Once, while drunk, he wanted to come in and I wouldn't let him in. So he *slid* in — down the coal chute — how he managed it without getting stuck I'll never know. But once he did get stuck — in one of those old stationary bathtubs we had in the kitchen (he was always taking baths) and somebody had to go down and pull him loose—that "somebody" happened to be me!

"Sad things happened also. One man committed suicide after he had stolen a lot of our clothes and our only suitcase. But all told it was a marvelous experience, and we learned a tremendous amount. We were one big family. In the early days, the families were a part of this society; we considered ourselves as much a part of A.A. as the drunks. I suppose the idea came from the Oxford Groups in which A.A. really had its roots. The Oxford Groups fellowship was open to anybody and everybody.

"So now we have two fellowships, and it isn't a bit strange that we of Al-Anon have fashioned our society after A.A. To me it is a most wonderful and beautiful fellowship, with the highest and most inspiring principles. I want to thank you all for showing us in Al-Anon the way."

DON W.:

"Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship—designed and administered by a bunch of ex-drunks. It has no rules, dues or fees—which other organizations seem to require. At meetings the speakers start on one subject and end up talking about something entirely different, concluding by saying, 'I don't really know anything about the program except that it works.'

"Nothing is ever planned more than 24 hours ahead—yet great projects are born and survive magnificently. Nothing in A.A. is according to Hoyle—how can it survive? Perhaps it is because we have learned to laugh at ourselves; Perhaps God is pleased with our poor efforts and makes everything right no matter who pushes the wrong buttons. Maybe He is pleased not with our perfection but with our sincerity. Maybe He is pleased because we are trying to be nobody but ourselves."

WYN D.:

"I still get goose pimples thinking of the things I did in blackouts, how I became a schemer and a conniver in order to get what I needed to drink. And through it all I didn't know that it was the first drink that got me drunk.

"Then I spent five years on the wagon, without coming to A.A. and people got very sick of me being dry. More than one told me that I was more fun when I drank. And it was true. I went through life like a zombie. It had no meaning. I started drinking again and after two and a half years called A.A.

"I haven't had a drink since and I've tried sincerely to follow the A.A. way of life. Years ago, one of my boys asked me not to go to church with him when he was being confirmed because I was drunk. Lately he told me, 'Gee, I'm glad you're an alcoholic. Your whole sense of values has changed.'"

CHARLIE D.:

"I don't ever remember drinking socially. I thought you should drink all you could, for as long as you could until you were drunk. First there was trouble with the juvenile authorities and then the adult cops took over. I did a lot of things drunk and nothing sober. If I didn't have money for liquor I'd steal it.

"I got married and my wife began to give me trouble. I wound up in jail on the same day she was going to have a baby. My liver started to deteriorate and I kept getting arrested. When she finally kicked me out, I called A.A. with an honest desire to get those people off my back.

"But I found more than that. Recently my wife and I were able to adopt a little boy even though they know I am an alcoholic. My mother came into the program about a year ago. I found God, love, and you people in A.A."

Work of Delegates Strengthens Fellowship

If a single voice will be heard, I offer mine in a prayer to God that this responsibility will continue long after my service as a trustee has ended and that all those present at this Conference will be blessed and enlightened to create a unity of voice that will be heard and remembered.

The "Third Legacy Manual" notes that an A.A. Tradition states that our program should never be "organized"; should always remain "nonprofessional." Also, that there is no authority in A.A. except that which expresses itself through the group conscience. The structure of our Fellowship begins with the G.S.R., the area committees, to the delegate. The Board of Trustees thus receives its direction from *you*.

The delegates carry the heavy influence in the Conference. This is felt in two ways: (1) They make up the Conference Committees, covering just about all kinds of A.A. activities, and (2) All delegates have free access to the Conference platform for the discussion of all actions affecting the movement.

You would be providing additional service if you contribute to this Conference wisely. Question not only the affairs of this Conference, but your ability to maintain with vision issues that affect this Conference and the future of our Fellowship. Be willing, therefore, to accept gracefully the decision of the majority; placing principles before personalities. Very often we lose contact with what is good for A.A. by being unwilling to listen. We believe we know best. Sometimes this is so, but more often it is not. There is, however, a time when one must and should stand up for one's convictions. Perhaps the group has not heard your voice clearly. Be courageous, be strong; be willing to be a voice that can be heard: on the other hand, be gracious if not too many listen.

Your work here may well be the contributing influence that will strengthen our Fellowship in the eyes and hearts of mankind, to provide a stabilizing influence toward living and a strengthening factor in time of stress or danger. The future is unpredictable, but I feel certain that if we maintain our principles, guard against bigness and power structures, do not tamper with our Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, we will remain strong, providing a service without fear.

The General Service Office staff, its manager, or the Board of Trustees, act only by your instruction. Delegates are the spokesmen sent here to delegate, to evaluate and to protect our Fellowship. What will be presented to you during this Conference comes from past Conferences, from delegates, past and present, from the newest member, from the Loners and the overseas groups. They ask for your direction. The responsibility is placed with you.

There is a question as to whose voice we hear when we ponder the future of our Fellowship. Whose conscience do we reflect in the decisions made here at this Conference?

The General Service Office staff? The general manager or Board of Trustees? Our own? Not at all! None of these! You serve A.A. as a whole...this service begins within the A.A. group from which your direction comes. Only through that can our group conscience, the voice of A.A., be truly reflected and heard.

—Maurice R., *Regional Trustee*
Southeast Region

DELEGATES WELCOMED TO CONFERENCE

My experience at last year's Conference was without doubt the greatest experience of my life. I am looking forward with anticipation to this Conference, as I know all of you are. No words of advice from me are necessary, nor would they help you. You will each have your own experience, and what you get will depend upon what you are willing to give. If each one of us gives only the best in us, we will be able to fulfill our responsibility to the Fellowship. May we earnestly ask for help in humility and truth, so that God, as we understand Him, may reveal to us a plan for the future, so that we may come to see new and better ways to carry the message. May the lines of communication be cleared and broadened so that we may enter new halls of understanding of the needs of others and consider new ways in which we may serve and be of service.

May we then approach the week now ahead of us conscious of our dependence upon God. May we be humbly resolved to put out our best efforts, with good humour, and willingness to let the other guy be wrong if he wants to. May I be conscious that I am not a regional delegate; I am a delegate with regional knowledge. I am not here to represent; I am here to serve. I do not serve my area first; I serve A.A. first.

I am most grateful to have the opportunity again to meet and share with all of you. You are people who have given years of service in A.A. to the work of the Third Legacy. You know what the Third Legacy is, you know what work is, and you have firsthand experience with Love and Service in Action. Because of my experience in sobriety, I have faith in the Legacy of Recovery; because of my experience in the traditions of my group and area and province, I have faith in the Legacy of Unity; because of the honesty, open-mindedness, and willingness of all of you delegates, I have found the greatest of faith in the Third Legacy of Service—or as we like to phrase it—Love and Service—as exemplified and manifested by and through the workings and deliberations of this Conference.

—Tom G., *Chairman*
Area Delegates

Digest of Agenda

Monday, April 21

Registration and Tour of G.S.O. and GV.
Welcome Session and Keynote – Group Conscience
Staff Hi-Lites
G.S.B. and Policy Committee Reports
A.A.W.S. Report
Review of Agenda, Committees
Opening Dinner: Regular A.A. Meeting.

Tuesday, April 22

Joint Meetings of Trustees and Conference Committees.
Conference Committee Meetings
World Service Meeting Report
Board Finance Report
Public Information Report and Presentation
Workshop: Public Information

Wednesday, April 23

Presentation: Group Conscience
Nominating Committee Report
Regional Trustee Election
Workshop: Communications Within A.A.
Conference Committee Meetings
Delegates' Only Dinner and Meeting

Thursday, April 24

Grapevine Presentation
Report: Area Delegates' Meeting
Presentation: Group Conscience And G.S.O.
Workshop: Young People
Literature Committee Report
Presentation: Current Attitudes and Approaches
International Committee Report
Presentation: Institutions
1970 Convention Report
Workshop: Alternate Delegate

Friday, April 25

Conference Committee Reports
Presentation: Area Service Meetings
Relationship of A.A. and Al-Anon
Report Back on Workshops
Closing Statement

Saturday, April 26

Closing Brunch

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"AREA HIGHLIGHTS": Each day time was set aside to hear area delegates of Panel 19 report on A.A. in their territories. Excerpts from these are carried on pages 23-25.

"ASK-IT-BASKET": Questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered at various times. Summaries appear pages 31 and 32.

Conference Seen as Voice of A.A.

While we are familiar enough with "structure" at the local level, there is apparently considerable confusion about the structure and purposes of G.S.O., the "Board," A.A.W.S., and the Grapevine, and about their relationship with each other and with the Conference.

Through some oversimplification it may be possible to obtain a better understanding of our overall structure. First, it is A.A. members who really run A.A. This is done through the groups, because the group is our basic unit of "structure"—like the cell in biology. Individual members who comprise the groups exercise their franchise through G.S.R.'s, area committees, and ultimately, through the delegates.

Now, let's look at the Conference. That's where the action is. But what is the Conference? What does it do? And why does it exist?

Well, first of all, it's the guardian of our Twelve Traditions. So says the Conference Charter. The Conference does this "guarding" through its chief service arm, the General Service Board.

Also, through the Board, the *Conference is responsible for our world services*. That's what G.S.O. does—provide these services.

And finally, most important of all, *the Conference is the Voice of A.A.* So what more appropriate theme could we have for this, our 19th annual meeting?

Now let's take a look at the Board. This used to be called the "Alcoholic Foundation." This is an *incorporated trusteeship*, composed of both alcoholics and non-alcoholics.

Its duties and responsibilities are primarily custodial—it is the custodian of our Twelve Traditions, our money and of our services.

It is the "service" arm of our Conference. It provides services all over the world through its two subsidiary corporations—A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine.

Now, let's take a quick look at A.A.W.S. The Board "owns" A.A.W.S. And what is A.A.W.S.? It's a publishing company (4 books, about 30 pamphlets, directories, handbooks, wall plaques, wallet cards, etc.)

A.A.W.S. "looks after" A.A.'s business interests, and employs all G.S.O. personnel, except Grapevine personnel, of course.

Now, let's take a look at another service arm of the Board. Grapevine, too, is a subsidiary of the Board.

Group Conscience Guides A.A. to the Right And Away From the Wrong

Within the meaning of the group conscience, it is the power and principles of this spiritually based society that should guide us to the right and away from the wrong.

It was very early in the history of these Conferences that we became profoundly aware of the underlying strength of the power of these principles. We learned in keeping with this definition of the group conscience that we must never seek compromise, but always certainty.

We must never use the force of a majority to impose changes on a minority. The strength of our Fellowship is such that it can always afford to delay changes until we know that such changes respond to the needs of all of A.A. and not to a simple majority.

Responsibility to A.A.

It must always be remembered that we have, in terms of the group conscience, a deep and abiding responsibility to all of A.A. that no changes ought to be made unless very nearly all of us are certain that we are being guided to the right and away from the wrong. Out of this flows the need ever to respect the views of the minority for they, too, as individuals in their relation to the group, may be guided to the right as they see it and away from the wrong.

In keeping with our group conscience, we would like to see all of those who suffer from the disease of alcoholism find a means of recovery. We know from our own individual experience that our Society cannot reach every alcoholic.

Perhaps there are those whose spiritual reservoirs have been so completely emptied that they are no longer capable of being refilled through the energizing effect of our Twelve Steps. So we welcome the efforts of every segment of our society attempting, through other means, to help these individuals achieve sobriety. We in A.A. do not claim any monopoly over the means of achieving sobriety.

Way to Sobriety Unique with A.A.

Indeed, while sobriety is the end we seek to achieve, it is the means by which we attain sobriety that renders this Fellowship so altogether unique. For we believe, as Aldous Huxley in "Ends and Means" said, "The end cannot justify the means, for the simple and obvious reason that the means employed determine the nature of the end produced. Our personal experience and the study of history make it abundantly clear that the means whereby we try to achieve something are at least as important as the end we wish to attain. Indeed, they are even more important. For the means employed inevitably determine the nature of the result achieved."

One cannot review that which has taken place in each of the General Service Conferences since the first one in

1951 without being constantly reminded of the power of the group conscience in action. Resolutions that were adopted, those that were defeated, those that were tabled and later adopted or defeated, the discussions that took place as the pro and con of each of these resolutions were soberly debated, remind us constantly of the power of the group conscience.

Definition for Fellowship

In the first General Service Conference of A.A., I sought to define the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous, and I stated that the best definition I had ever heard was one I listened to while in London in a broadcast delivered by Canon C.E. Raven, a noted British religious leader. I was so impressed with this definition as applicable to the Society of A.A. that I obtained a copy thereof and read it at our first Conference. Canon Raven defined the conditions of a true fellowship in these words:

"Three conditions are necessary for true fellowship: the possession of a common ideal, involving a complete release from selfishness and division. The discharge of a common task, big enough to capture the imagination and give expression to loyalty. And the comradeship, the 'togetherness' thus involved as we find out the joy and power of belonging to an organic society and engaging in a whole-time service We can find it at its fullest extent where the ideal is highest and most exacting, where the task extends and integrates every ounce of our strength and every element of our being, where the comradeship is so solid and deep that we respond one to another without conscious effort, realize the unspoken need and react to it spontaneously and at once."

In the eighteen years that have elapsed since I spoke those words, the Fellowship of A.A., within the meaning of this definition, has grown in strength and in content.

Let the group conscience continue to guide this inspired Fellowship, so that it may do for all others for all time what it has done for you.

—Bernard B. Smith, former Chairman
General Service Board

NEW FEATURE ON AGENDA

Your G.S.O. staff, trustees, directors and department heads shared a little bit about themselves via a new feature inaugurated at the Conference this year; a series of "hi-lite" talks, three minutes each, giving each one the opportunity to get better acquainted with all conference members.

Delegates Work to Develop Group Conscience

Presentation

"Together we represent all the A.A. groups and members of the United States and Canada," said Fernand I., chairman. "And we also,

in an indirect way, represent probably all the members all over the world. Thus it is important that we try to understand what 'group conscience' really means."

MORE INFORMATION NEEDED

Here is one example of an uninformed group conscience—a note on anonymity which was read to groups and newcomers in my area. It mentions the fact that anonymity is a matter of personal choice and the spiritual foundation of the program, as well as the fact that it should be maintained at public meetings or at the level of press, radio, and films.

I heard about it recently after it had been brought up and roundly discussed. I was asked to bring it to the attention of the Conference, to see if it could be included in a piece of literature on the subject. When I read the note carefully, however, I could see that everything mentioned was already included in our existing literature. And this, to my way of thinking, is an example of uninformed group conscience. At the same time I can see where it is wrong to assume that everybody knows about what is available on what subject. Thus we all have a job of education in the area of communications—to let our members know what is available and then let them decide what else is needed.

—Bill B., San Diego, California

TRADITIONS SHOULD BE STUDIED

Does the group conscience always work for the best of the group and A.A. as a whole? Sometimes it would seem to fail us, as shown by the experience of Duluth groups a few years ago.

Things had been going along quite well. The Steps of recovery were discussed and studied at the meetings, experiences were shared, newcomers were welcomed.

However, something was missing. Seldom were the Twelve Traditions discussed and the only time G.S.O. was mentioned was when the area committee member got up enough nerve to bore them with a talk about the "New York Office."

Then the groups were forced to look for a new meeting place. After a time it was decided that the only thing to

do was purchase a building. Then it was suggested that the groups apply in the name of the Alano Society for a loan to help meet the purchase price.

A majority said that this would not violate the Tradition of self-support, since the grant would be applied for in the name of Alano, rather than in the name of A.A. As a result, a grant of \$10,000 was obtained. Everyone was overjoyed since A.A. had obtained ideal clubrooms and a meeting place for almost nothing.

The joy did not last too long. There were personality clashes and a general attitude of "they don't need my support because they've got that \$10,000."

That was three years ago. Some of the wounds are just beginning to heal. Now many members are becoming acutely aware of the wealth of experience available in New York and of the necessity of participating in all three Legacies of A.A.

In the past several months, six of the nine groups have elected G.S.R.'s, and four of them even attended the last assembly meeting. A Birthday Club has been formed and has been well received. —Dave H., Northern Minnesota

'UNDERSTANDING, THE KEY. . .'

The greatest enemy of group conscience is apathy. We are all at fault if we do not take an active part in group functions and area affairs.

To share in our group conscience we must also participate. Too often we tend, as we go along in A.A., to take the line of least resistance, the old "peace at any price" attitude. This allows the oldtimer or newcomer with the most dominating personality and loudest voice to be our group conscience.

The group that listens to all its voices with an open mind and has a good understanding of the principles of A.A. is guided in its decisions by principles and not personalities. Whenever any problem comes up, whether it be money, rotation, 12th-Step work or institution commitments, talking out at a group meeting somehow resolves it without any difficulty. "Understanding is the key to right principles and right attitudes."

There is apt to be a tendency to skip over or omit reports of G.S.R.'s at group meetings because they are too boring or time consuming. By allowing this, we fail to remind all members of our responsibility to A.A. as a whole. The new member needs to hear about and understand these Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service. It is only gradually that new members realize that service to others is a necessary part of their own recovery.

—Ruth L., Rhode Island

Area Service Key to Being Real Part of A.A.

Presentation

"A.A. to me is like a great circle or wheel. When we first come into A.A. we are on the outside," said Katharine P., chairman. "Many are content to stay there but only barely. I think, however, that the further you work yourself in, the less likely you are to fall out of the circle. It starts with emptying ash trays and performing any service you are asked, because service is very definitely at the center of the circle. This makes the wheel turn and perform its destined purpose in the lives of all A.A. members."

ASSEMBLY MEETINGS THRIVE

In Georgia we hold our assembly meetings three times a year, but expect to start meeting quarterly in the future. We mail individual letters to G.S.R.'s and committeemen about ten days before, encouraging attendance and suggesting that they bring their alternate as well.

There is an open meeting on Saturday night, followed by refreshments and fellowship. On Sunday morning there is a workshop and sharing session for G.S.R.'s and committeemen who report on activities, discuss and seek solutions to group and district problems.

Attendance at the assembly meetings has been good and is growing. Unity is becoming more of a reality. This is being accomplished by giving our G.S.R.'s and committeemen more responsibility and opportunity to share in A.A. service. Any subject concerning a decision is voted upon, so that each group has the right to express its voice. There is a feeling of individual representation and accomplishment.

Twenty-five years ago individual state conventions in the southeast were few and small in scope. Thus it was suggested that a conference for the entire area might serve a useful purpose. The Southeast Convention has helped to strengthen the growth of A.A. in the Southeast region.

The annual past and Present Southeast Delegates Get-Together is another event that serves a useful purpose in our area. It is not only helpful to first-year delegates who are able to benefit from the wisdom and experience of those who have preceded them, but it helps to keep past delegates active in service work. —Joe C., Georgia

'SYMPOSIUM ON SERVICE'

The increasing need in our area to provide a knowledge of service and stimulate interest in current G.S.O. activities resulted in an area service workshop called "Symposium on Service," or S.O.S.

The theme and format of this meeting, "Delegate for a Day," intended that participants "Carry home with them the vision of a great movement in action."

While there is an increasing interest in service, far too many members refuse to become involved.

One feature which attracted attention was a workshop-type session, presenting certain problems and solutions. This was followed by a prepared true-and-false test. Answers were then explained from the podium. Then the meeting was broken up into small groups of eight. An actual solution (if any) was noted, then the groups discussed a better solution (if any). The leaders then gave their reports during lunch and dinner.

The result was a spirited meeting. But the most interesting end result is that when problems arise now members tend to go back for solutions to the text books we used all day: "The Third Legacy Manual"; "The G.S.R.," and the A.A. Group Handbook.

Many members were surprised to find that there are answers for Tradition problems, just as there are answers in the Big Book for the Steps and recovery. The sum total result of the session was an almost magical removal for many members of the stigma of service.

—Warren S., So. Coastal, California

G.S.R. WORKSHOPS HELPFUL

Our area service meeting is referred to as a G.S.R. Workshop. At the beginning we suggest a few basic rules to the groups: (1) The group G.S.R. should be there, (2) The group should finance his trip, covering expenses, (3) The G.S.R. should understand that the meeting is not a social gathering. He is requested not to bring his wife, (4) The group should also send its new G.S.R. every second year, even though he hasn't officially taken over, (5) The group should have a full turnout to hear the G.S.R.'s report when he returns.

The first thing we do at the workshop is hold a General Service Conference Committee meeting so that every G.S.R. can see our provincial committee in action. All reports are written. This is followed by a treasurer's report and then a report from the delegate.

What surprised those of us closer to the scene was the number of things that were unknown or unclear to G.S.R.'s. We used this opportunity to discuss, explain, and suggest. Results are quite evident in our province, Saskatchewan's per capita contributions in 1968: \$2.46; Canada, \$1.83, and the United States, \$2.13. We feel that the business of A.A. is important business. We no longer find it difficult to talk about money in our province. And it is because of these workshops that Saskatchewan had no trouble in getting many committeemen and G.S.R.'s to attend the Western Canada Workshop in Calgary.

—Jack C., Saskatchewan

Missing General Service Activities

Seen as Missing the Heart of A.A.

Presentation

"Sometimes I think too many of us get too active in any organization, even A.A.," said Andy A., chairman. As a result we take in a lot of side shows, but never get into the Big Top. In other words, we miss General Service. And to me this is missing the heart of A.A."

NEWCOMERS AWARE OF SERVICE

It is up to us so-called oldtimers to take the Fourth and Tenth Steps for a moment and see where we fit into the picture regarding new attitudes and approach to service responsibility. Do we do our part to see that newcomers are aware of these opportunities to serve, or do we see a threat to our status? When they are ready for service, are we willing to release it to them? Thus, one answer to the question as to the difference in the approach to the program and service responsibility of the new member from the old, if any, might well be that the old member is not properly meeting his responsibility.

However, a new member asking this same question could be just as concerned, because he feels the old approach to the program and service responsibility is not meeting the needs of the more recent member and our changing times. And when it comes to an answer I don't know whether new members have a different approach to the program and service responsibility. But I don't think that the type of approach matters so much as the fact that A.A. meets the need of the alcoholic today and its hand is there when anyone, anywhere reaches out for help. This is the guarantee of sound perpetuation.

---Tom M., Tennessee

NEW GENERATION OF OLDTIMERS

What I call the A.A. generation gap is not youth versus age. It is length of sobriety—10 years and under versus 10 years and over. This seems to be the dividing line, in New Hampshire at least.

A few years back there were fewer groups and membership per group was much smaller.

Then the groups started to grow. People left their original groups and started new ones. These groups prospered. The new people were staying sober and becoming responsible members. As more and more people kept coming and staying sober and getting responsible, the new generation of oldtimers began looking for new things to do.

Public information was seen to be a great need, so that the sick and suffering alcoholic could find us more readily. It was seen that the general public needed to be informed as to what, who, and where we were. Coordinating group activities, publishing meeting lists and other services for the groups were seen to be needed and they were done. A need was seen for broader forms of A.A. activity, such as conventions and banquets that couldn't be handled at the group level. There was also a need to broaden the A.A. experience of the newcomer. These efforts met with varying degrees of success. More importantly, these efforts established the scene of action and new people gravitated to this scene. Today our area can point to considerable progress in these areas. We have improved our relationships with the public and public alcoholism agencies. Our only real concern would seem to be that, like all alcoholics, we want to go twice as far, twice as fast.

---Neil G., New Hampshire

A DIFFERENT APPROACH

There seems to be a great deal of difference in the approach to service and responsibility between newer and older members. Service and responsibility must, in a way, be learned. Most of us don't know anything about this when we first come into A.A. We haven't even heard of the Twelve Steps, let alone the Traditions. Many don't get any knowledge of the Traditions or the "Third Legacy Manual" for quite some time, and then only what is forced upon them.

Some newcomers wish to learn all they can about A.A. They volunteer for various committees and help with chores right from the beginning. Some go along slow and easy, always willing to help when asked. They can always be counted on when needed, but seldom go ahead on their own. Others—the Cloud Niners—are so happy they want everyone to know it. They want to sober up the world overnight.

I feel it is impossible to judge the true responsibility of a member until he has been in A.A. for from one to three years. Up to this time he may be content to go slow, listen, and stay sober. The person with five years or more seems to be getting settled in all ways. His life seems to have settled down and his serenity shows. He comes to meetings regularly, listens attentively, gives good advice when asked, helps with committees and is very stable. His comments show good A.A. judgment.

Many a new member seems to feel that the older member has a responsibility to keep him sober and that his own responsibility will begin when he has more time in A.A. He has yet to learn that it is only when we care enough to share that we truly reap the full rewards of the A.A. way of life.

---Hal V., No. Dakota

Wide Range of Services to Institutions

Presentation

"I feel that A.A. members generally think about penitentiaries and jails when the word 'institutions' comes up," said Bob H., chairman. "I feel we should think about institutions on a much wider scale as covering hospitals, half-way houses, court programs and jailhouses among others."

HELPING HAND TO INMATES

I take my hat off to the many A.A. committees, sponsors and members who have gone into institutions of every type, have brought into them the helping hand and the shining hope of A.A., have won the confidence of prisoners and the cooperation of officials and are waiting at the gates when those who have begun to believe that a return to sanity and sobriety may be possible come out.

The success A.A. has had under almost unbeatable conditions with jail prisoners whom most people consider beyond help and not worth helping is a bright, shining star in its crown. I hope it will inspire more and more A.A. members to go into these abodes of defeat and despair and bring light and hope where there has been none.

—Austin MacCormick, Trustee
General Service Board

COMMITTEE EARNS TRUST

The Los Angeles Institutional Committee, one of seven in Southern California, was formed 22 years ago. It serves 57 institutions and consists of 400 to 800 members. Over the years the committee has earned the trust, respect, and confidence of the officials of all institutions in which they operate. This kind of situation can be initiated by a visit with the top official of the institution in which meetings are about to be started. A meeting of the minds is sought and the official assured that all regulations will be followed, but that A.A. will conduct its meeting according to the Twelve Traditions.

All A.A. members are urged to attend the committee's monthly meetings, but one year of sobriety is required in order to become a panel member. The committee is self-supporting through collections from its own membership, contributions to the "Buck-of-the-Month" Club, and dinners served on several occasions each year.

Following are some guidelines used for speakers: (1) An A.A. member on probation or parole may not speak at a correctional institution without official written permission, (2) Talks shall be confined to A.A. life stories, A.A. principles and/or A.A. general information, (3) Speakers are encouraged to emphasize how the program of A.A. worked

for them, rather than give a blow-by-blow account of their drinking, (4) Profanity is discouraged and no talks dealing with drug addiction are permitted. No verbal or written messages are taken in or out of the institution, and speakers refrain from commenting on institution personnel, facilities, policies, or practices, (5) Inmates are not to be promised help in the name of A.A., in securing an early release, a job, financial assistance, or any other material benefit.

—Art K., So. California

INMATES RUN GROUP

There are 11 registered hospital groups in the Western Ontario area. The one I am most familiar with is the Hamilton Psychiatric Hospital.

Eleven years ago we were asked to arrange a weekly A.A. meeting at the hospital, and it has been going strong ever since. Some things I have found useful: (1) Attempt to make the patients feel that it is their group and that we are there to try to help them, (2) Avoid discussion of hospital treatment, psychiatry, rules or regulations, (3) Attempt to have the patients ask questions, (4) Circulate and talk with patients during the coffee hour, (5) Discuss alcoholism and the A.A. program only.

We get about 20 to 25 patients at our weekly meetings with about the same number of members from outside. We are fully self-supporting, contributing to G.S.O. and Ontario General Service.

How successful is this work with hospitals. I think it is tremendous. I know 15 or 20 good A.A. members who got their start while at the hospital.

—Wyn D., Western Ontario

ATTEND OUTSIDE MEETINGS

In the Southern Wisconsin area we have a state prison, a state prison farm, two state hospitals, a rehabilitation hospital, two Veterans Administration hospitals, a few half way houses and several country hospitals. A.A. meetings are held in all of these.

At some hospitals, patients may be permitted to attend outside meetings. They are encouraged to pick their own sponsor. Or, some groups appoint the sponsors. It has been noted that some members are willing to sponsor a patient from a hospital, but are hesitant about sponsoring an inmate from a prison. Those who attend meetings in institutions are usually more willing to become sponsors than those who don't. In general, however, it is gratifying to see how ready A.A. members are to accept the former inmates and patients. —Martin T., Southern Wisconsin

Group Conscience Most Important Guide In Making Grapevine the Voice of A.A.

Presentation

"In all our efforts on the editorial and corporate boards," said Ed L., chairman, "the group conscience is the most important guide we have.

We must be very careful that this magazine is not the voice of one man or the voice of the various boards or even the voice of General Services. We have to try to make it the voice of all A.A. and we have to consider what the group conscience would think on any given problem. This happens in the selection of articles, in the number of articles in a given issue, in our business affairs and in employee relations."

MOST ARTICLES COME IN MAIL

I see my job as editor of the Grapevine as a responsibility for seeing that a certain amount of typewritten manuscript appears monthly in an attractive package, well laid out, balanced as to intent and, hopefully, with as few mistakes as possible.

The Grapevine can certainly be called the voice of A.A. Approximately 75% of the contents of every issue comes from the Fellowship through the mail. Of the remaining 25%, much comes from the Grapevine's editorial board, made up of A.A.'s having professional writing experience. The board meets monthly to evaluate the magazine, tear it apart and put it back together again. Out of this will come ideas for articles and these will be taken on as assignments by members of the board.

One of my chief concerns is the appearance of the magazine. I would like it to be pleasing; to look like a magazine for mature people. We have five or six professional artists who are in A.A. and these people contribute art work for the cover and inside stories. We also have some professional gag cartoonists and others who do wonderful cartoons for us. Finally, there is the Once-Over-Lightly column which depends on anecdotes received from readers. Tell everyone to keep sending these in. Humor is a great help to recovery: when we begin to laugh at ourselves, we are really on the way.

—Jack M., Editor

THE MOST EXCITING OFFICE

During this Conference we have heard instances which prove the group conscience is alive and at work in the individual, in the group, and surely in A.A. itself. But we hope and expect to hear this of A.A.; it is evident to those of us who have a daily familiarity with the A.A. Traditions.

Is it any wonder that the message which goes monthly to 52,000 A.A.'s from the Grapevine is a product of our group conscience in print? Yes, it is to me.

I've worked in many busy offices before, but the busiest, the roughest and the most exciting one I've ever worked in is the Grapevine.

With a small staff, deadlines to meet every day of the week, manuscripts to read, letters to answer, lists to the mailing house, copy to the printer, editing, cutting, correction, and telephones—how could a group conscience get into the act?

Isn't it up to the editor to do 'his thing,' the managing editor to mind everyone's business, the circulation manager to tell off the managing editor or the bookkeeper to tell everyone off—just once in a while? No, it really isn't. It's entirely up to one loving authority, as He expresses Himself through our group conscience—to tell everyone off when necessary.

My assignment covers first reading of all manuscripts and selection of current issues. This is the beginning, for it is a rare happening when my selection is not challenged, so my ego is never in danger of inflation. Not one issue is selected unilaterally.

How about writers? Wouldn't you think they would expect preferential treatment? Their material is contributed free. If they do, they certainly don't get it. Even an amateur is a pro at heart when he submits material to the Grapevine. "Do what you want with it," they say. "The writing of it was a big help to me."

—Paula C., Managing Editor

PRICE INCREASE POSSIBLE

At last year's Conference, we mentioned we were getting close to the point where it might be necessary to increase the price of the Grapevine. After reviewing our operations again, we find we haven't quite reached that point yet, but might be there in 1971.

In making such a decision, the board would be aware that the purpose of the Grapevine is not to make a profit, but to carry the message. We also know that we can avoid a price increase by a substantial increase in circulation. This is not only possible but desirable, because many A.A.'s are not at all aware of the Grapevine.

So our real message to you is that we hope you will go back and make other A.A.'s aware that there ought to be many more readers of the Grapevine—for their own sake and because it is a very important way of carrying the message. It is a magazine in which everybody's voice can be heard.

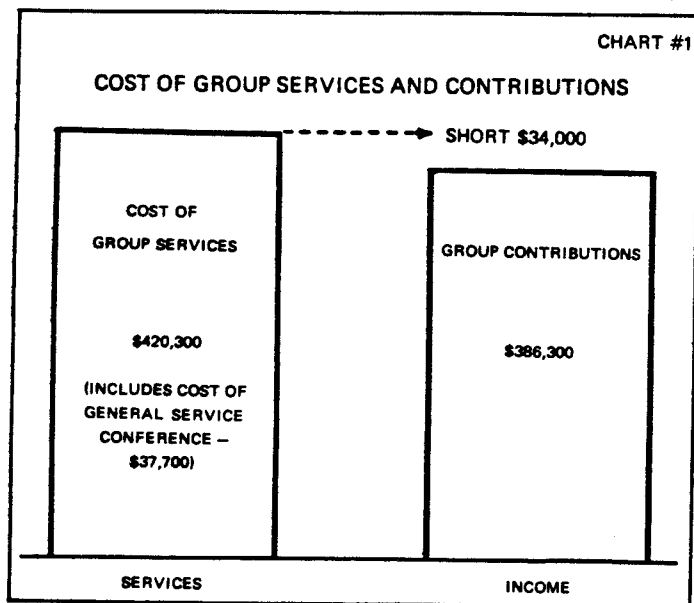
—Ruth W., Treasurer

G.S.O. Income and Expense

Presentation

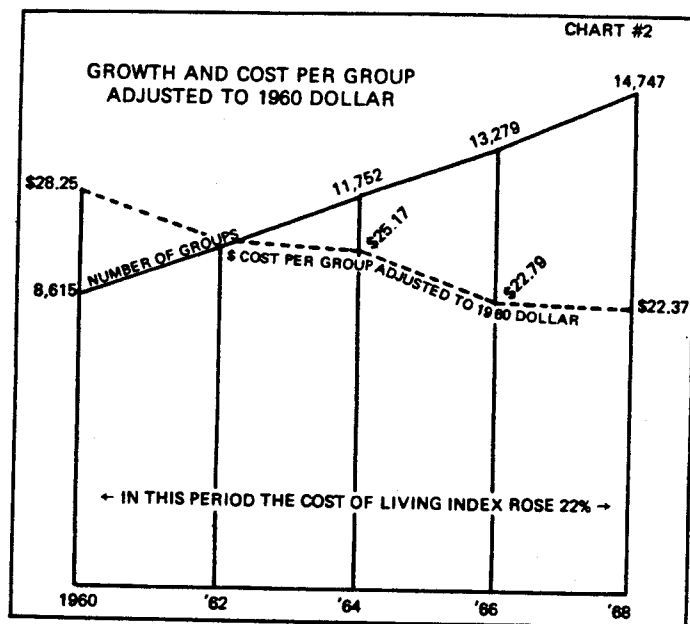
As in any other well-run business, G.S.O. plots its income and expense on an annual basis. The financial structure is simple, but it *looks* complicated when you try to show it in detail on an income statement, or balance sheet, or budget. Also these reports do not point up our biggest problem; that is, a deficit budget for the greater part of the year. I believe these simple charts will help tell the story.

First, to pull the whole picture into perspective: chart #1 shows service costs on the left and group contributions on the right, as provided for in the 1969 budget. Contributions should match group services, but they haven't for years. Therefore, before considering any other source of income, we anticipate a contribution shortage of \$34,000. At this point, with the cost of group services exceeding anticipated group contributions, our deficit budget is in the making.



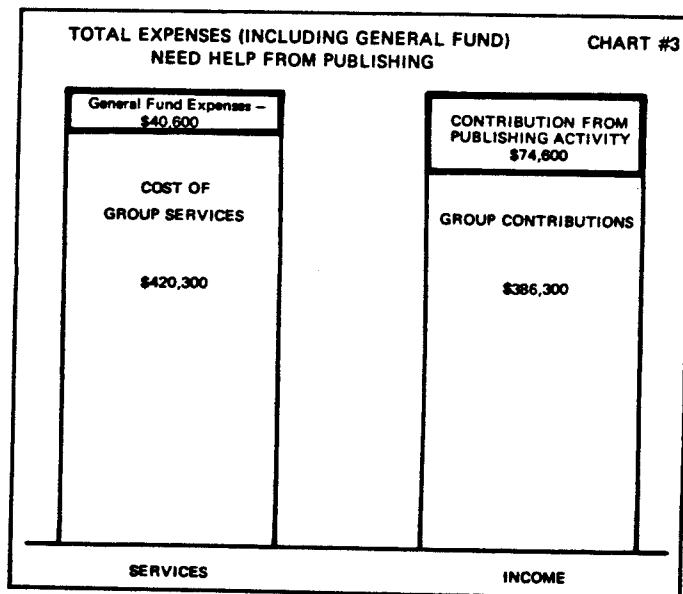
This year, as in most years, the cost of group services is expected to exceed group contributions. Even though the Finance & Budgetary Committee has planned the budget to get the most out of every contribution dollar received, it is anticipated that contributions will fall short of group service expenses by \$34,000.

We are constantly doing what we can to cut basic costs so that inflation and the cost of more services to more groups will still leave us with a workable budget. Without reducing group services, the service cost per group has been kept from rising. Chart #2 shows that when we adjust to the 1960 dollar, the service cost per group has actually declined. In 1960, with 8,615 groups registered, the annual cost per group was \$28.25. Allowing for the 22% cost-of-living increase since that time, the adjusted 1968 cost was actually down to \$22.37 per group.



Year after year, the Fellowship grows and the dollar develops less purchasing power — with the result that G.S.O. service costs increase. However, without reducing group services, constant striving for increased efficiency and economy has kept the service cost per group from rising.

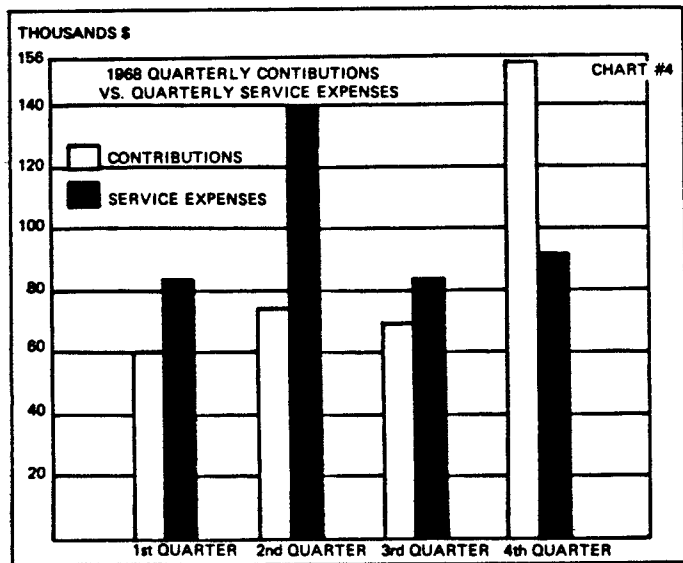
Chart #2 shows that when the cost of service is adjusted to a 1960 base, the annual service cost per group actually decreased from \$28.25 to \$22.37.



Expenses other than group services must also be met. General Fund expenses, totaling \$40,600, represent the cost of Board meetings, Public Information activities, special projects authorized by the Board, etc. Combined costs of General Fund and Group Services now total \$460,900. However, Publishing activity anticipates a \$87,200 net income for the year after paying its own share of operating expenses. Of this amount, \$74,600 will be contributed toward these expenses.

Chart #3 shows us that there are other expenses to be met. On the left side of the chart we see that the General Fund expenses, representing the cost of holding trustee meetings, the P.I.C. budget, and other special projects of the Board, add \$40,600 to our overall expenses. The right side of the chart shows how the budget is balanced by an assist from publishing. Our book and pamphlet business, after paying its own share of operating expenses, should have \$74,600 left over to contribute to the pot, thus balancing our budget for the year.

Even though a balanced budget is planned for the year, *we don't really know how we come out until the very end*

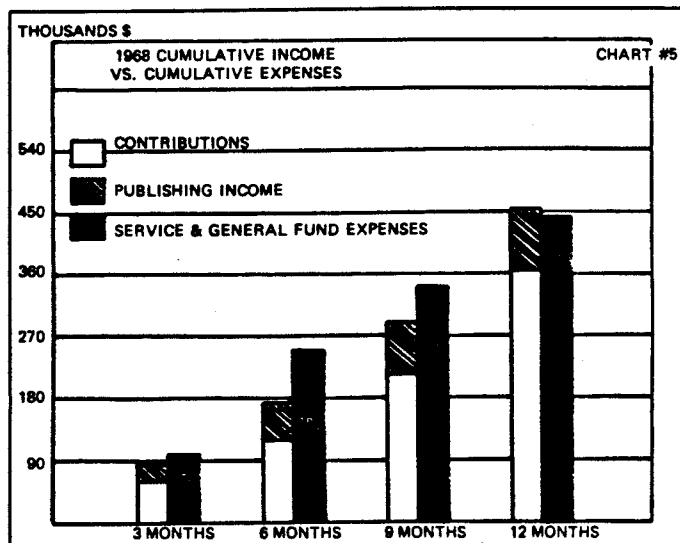


This chart illustrates the difficulty of budgeting against erratic contribution income. Even though expenses are incurred on a month to month and quarter to quarter basis, almost 40% of this income still comes in during the 4th quarter.

of the year. Chart #4 emphasizes the difficulty of budgeting against erratic contribution income. We can see that, on a quarter-by-quarter basis, service expenses by far out-strip group contributions for each of the first three quarters. We must keep in mind that about 40% of this year's contributions will not be received until the last three months of the year.

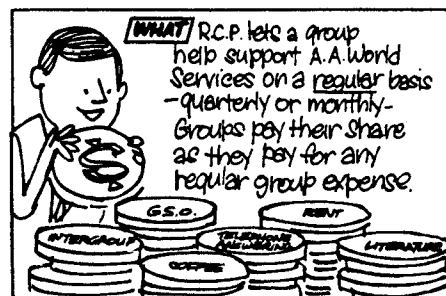
Chart #5 illustrates that even taking publishing income into consideration, there is still a net operating deficit for the first nine months or more of the year. In the meantime, we have to dip into Fund Capital to carry us along. A deficit budget is a dangerous practice, because you are spending money you don't really have but expect to get. This is the *why* of R.C.P. If more groups would use the *Regular Contribution Plan*, it would help make it possible for G.S.O. to operate on a pay-as-you-go basis. In other words, if all groups would contribute monthly or quarterly, our cash flow in would match our cash flow out. However, until this happens, we will continue to be faced with a net operating deficit for the first nine months or more of the year.

—Dennis Manders
Controller



Publishing income helps to carry the load but there is still a net operating deficit for the first nine months or more of the year.

REGULAR CONTRIBUTION PLAN



HOW

A Group can start anytime. . .figuring 25¢ per member for monthly contributions . . . or 75¢ per member for each quarterly contribution

28th Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism

Provided Opportunities for Public Information

Presentation

We want to give you an example of the Public Information Committee in action and it seemed to us that the 28th International Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism held in Washington last September, in which many of us participated, would give members of this committee an opportunity to present a quick "thumbnail" of what he did, relative to P.I.C. work, in connection with that Congress.

The Congress was attended by about 2,000 people from 33 countries, including countries behind the Iron Curtain. Most of the people attending were scientific and professional people, and our objective was to take this opportunity to tell these scientific people from all over the world about A.A. We spent two years in participating in their planning meetings and in listening. We had a booth with the professional exhibit; special literature kits (1,500 of which were distributed), and a hospitality suite. As a result of the hospitality suite, Midge received an invitation to go to Budapest, Hungary, this year to speak at the International Institute of Alcohol and Drug Addiction.

—Bayard P., Jr., Chairman
Trustees' P.I. Committee

BAYARD P. BANQUET SPEAKER

The climax of the International Congress was the closing banquet. Bayard P., chairman of the Trustees' P.I.C., was invited to be the speaker of the evening.

Bayard discussed in a most definitive and penetrating way the whole subject of motivation and why the recovered alcoholic is invaluable, if not indispensable, in the recovery process. He used our survey findings, just released that day, to illustrate his points. In providing information to the public, he did a first-rate job of carrying the A.A. message to international professionals in the alcoholism field, and letting them know the hand of A.A. is always here.

—Cora Louise B., Staff
Information Service

LARGE PRESS TURNOUT

The 28th International Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism was covered by consumer and medical media from many parts of the world. Included were this nation's TV and radio networks, the wire services, medical publications, and such prominent daily newspapers as the *Washington Post*, *New York Times*, *Boston Globe* and *Atlanta Journal*.

Not only was the turnout good for the A.A. press conference, it was the biggest by far of any held during the Congress. For the first time, the matter of "gate crashing" became a problem. We were obliged to turn away dozens of people who wanted to see and hear Dr. Jack and Bill.

TV, radio, wire services, major daily newspapers, medical press and media representatives from England, Germany, France, Norway, Switzerland, The Netherlands, Sweden and many other countries were on hand.

—Walter M.

SURVEY HIGHLIGHTS STRESSED

The material we provided to participants at the Congress and to the press included a summary of the survey, which covered all of the salient facts and presented them in a simple, straightforward way. It was accompanied by a press release, which was also sent to local A.A. Public Information Committees.

The press release pointed up survey highlights in such a way that newspapermen were not required to wade through a great many unfamiliar statistics to get enough material to file a story. In addition to the figures, this story also provided media with our rationale for undertaking the survey. We also supplied guests and newspapermen with additional literature.

—Niles P.

NEED FOR SURVEY

For some time our friends in the medical profession, scientific community, and at various government agencies have been asking for some factual guidelines as to the size, scope, and effectiveness of Alcoholics Anonymous.

In response to these inquiries, the P.I. Committee began in 1966 to try to find some way of developing the information that our friends were asking for.

The ensuing survey was designed and supervised by highly qualified professional researchers with many years of experience.

Without the cooperation of the delegates, this survey would not have been possible. More than 11,000 A.A. members, a representative sample of all A.A. members attending meetings throughout the U.S. and Canada, filled out the survey questionnaire.

(cont'd on p. 39)

Young People in A.A.

KEEPING YOUNG PEOPLE IN A.A.

Participants find that too much emphasis is being placed on the young person in A.A.; that we should try to communicate on the one-alcoholic-to-another basis, remembering that A.A. works best for those who want it, rather than those who need it.

The big problem seems to be keeping the young person in A.A., rather than getting him to A.A. It is in the group itself where the generation gap is likely to occur.

If possible young newcomers should be introduced to people their own age, and older members should refrain from being over-patronizing. Generally, the young member has asked for help because of the trouble drinking has caused. How much, when, where or with whom isn't all that important. He should be treated like any other alcoholic.

We should remind young people that we need them and want them as much as they want us. They play a big part in our Fellowship. They are our leaders of tomorrow.

—Bob F., Reporter

DON'T DICTATE

In summary members of the workshop agreed that we can better communicate with under-thirty and teenage alcoholics:

1. By recognizing three general points: (1) They ask the right to participate, (2) They do not want to be dictated to, and (3) They need identification — not over-direction by "elder statesmen."
2. Encouraging them to participate in all levels of A.A. service.
3. By stressing that alcoholism is a disease; that age, sex, years of drinking, etc., are not important.
4. By having local P.I. Committees contact high schools and colleges to inform them of services available through speaker programs, booths, displays and personal help when necessary.
5. By finding ways to use young members who have returned to college, as well as teachers and others, in furthering our efforts in the colleges.
6. By including younger members in future filmstrips, radio announcements and literature for purposes of identification.

7. By avoiding the tendency to preach or dictate to younger members.

8. By avoiding a patronizing manner — this is resented more than anything else. —Chuck D., Reporter

HONEST APPROACH BEST

It seemed to be the consensus that when we first approach the young person, we should be honest and direct. The young person wants direct answers, and will feel more at ease if given the honest facts.

We should not talk down to them, but assume they have had as rough a road as we ourselves have had. We should also try to describe the feelings we had inside when we were their age and still drinking, rather than tell a blow-by-blow story.

We should talk about A.A. in general, how it worked for us.

Some areas report having great success with young people's groups, but also stated the members attend any number of other meetings.

We should remember that the most important person at a meeting is the new person, young or old.

—George M., Reporter

BETTER COMMUNICATIONS

1. How can we better communicate with the "under 30" alcoholic or teenager?

- A. Don't advise the young person how fortunate he is to have come in so young and missed all of the misery the older member has experienced.
- B. Don't tell the young member he is too young to be an alcoholic.
- C. Get young fellows and gals in the P.I. spot announcement.

2. Is the message being carried to alcoholics on the campus?

- A. This workshop knew of only one A.A. group on campus and that was in Montana.
- B. Some members of this workshop had college students in their groups. —George G., Reporter

Alternate Delegate

DUTIES OF ALTERNATE

Some of the duties of the alternate delegate include: being chairman of P.I.C.; setting up workshops and panels; General Service reporter for the local news bulletin; duty as a committee member, working on structure; duties that the regular delegate does not have time for.

It is felt to be unnecessary for the alternate to receive delegate mail. It is the responsibility of the delegate to keep his alternate informed.

All agree that it is a good idea for area committees to elect the alternate delegate. In some areas the alternate is the runner up in the delegate election. In others he is elected by separate vote.

Four areas report that all G.S.R. expenses are paid by the groups. In some areas where groups are concentrated assemblies are hosted by a group in the area and expenses are not necessary.

It was the feeling of most members of our workshop that automatic succession from state chairman to the office of delegate is not desirable. —Malvin P., Reporter

A NEW NAME

Participants suggest that the name "alternate" be changed to assistant or vice delegate and that he be used in such capacities as liaison officer with public information committees or in communicating with areas of his assembly, to act for the delegate at committee and G.S.R. meetings when the delegate is not able to be present.

When the distance factor makes it impossible for the delegate to cover his entire area, then the alternate could be of much help in assuming some of this work load. It was also stressed that close relationship between delegate and alternate was very desirable.

An alternate delegate who was informed that he had to attend the Conference reports that he had a hard time catching up on the Conference and suggests that the alternate receive the same mail as the delegate. Other participants feel that if the delegate thinks his alternate should receive copies of his mail then he should request it from G.S.O.

In one area a member serves two years as secretary, two years as chairman and then as delegate, although other nominees are invited at election time. Delegates feel

that election of the alternate should follow Third Legacy procedure.

Some participants report that G.S.R.'s are reimbursed either in full or in part while attending conferences.

—Bill G., Reporter

SHOULD SHARE DUTIES

Participants feel that the alternate delegate should share the duties and responsibilities of the delegate and that the amount of participation should be left to the delegate and/or his area or state committee.

The consensus is that the alternate should receive previous Conference "Ask-it-Basket" questions, history of the committee to which the delegate has been assigned, a monthly letter from the secretary, all proposals that are to come before the Conference and the agenda, in addition to regular mail received from G.S.O.

It is unanimously agreed that the area committee should elect an alternate delegate, although some participants prefer to elect a chairman who automatically becomes the alternate. Most areas use Third Legacy procedure in electing the alternate.

Money for G.S.R. expenses is available in some groups, but G.S.R.'s have refused to accept it. Other groups are considering this matter. Many feel this would help to increase attendance at area meetings because of the distance some G.S.R.'s have to travel. —Jim G., Reporter

AREA COMMITTEE SHOULD ELECT

Many participants report that the alternate delegate has no specific duties except to attend the Conference in case the regular delegate is unable to attend. Some work closely with the delegate, traveling over the state the same as he does. Others are looking forward to receiving information regarding their exact duties.

A third of the participants thought that alternate delegates should receive the same mail as delegates. Others thought that the alternate is now receiving enough information. Delegates were nearly unanimous in thinking that area committees should elect the alternate. In most cases they report that the alternate was second choice.

Most groups do not pay a G.S.R.'s expense, although some pay in full or part. A few participants were of the opinion that no expense should be paid.

—Orlando C., Reporter

Communications Within A.A.

FUNCTIONS OF INTERGROUPS

Better communications between general service area committees and intergroups can be obtained by having the meetings of each open to the other and by informing each other about what is going on.

Intergroups function through the contributions of group and individual contributions, with some areas asking for specific amounts or forming "buck-a-month" clubs. Central offices furnish literature and books to groups in their areas to raise money and sponsor anniversary meetings, dances, and other special functions.

Central offices help smaller groups in their areas by forming round robins which meet monthly in different locations. Usually a G.S.R. and committee meeting will be helpful in conjunction with the regular A.A. meeting.

One intergroup monthly provides all groups in its area with an A.A. calendar. Each group is given other groups to visit during that month.

In some areas newly formed groups are furnished with speakers, literature and other help by larger ones until they can operate on their own.

Loners are helped with literature, mail, and visits to those loneliest A.A.'s of all — the sick and infirm.

—Carl H., Reporter

REPRESENTATION HELPS

The consensus is that we can obtain broader communications with central offices by giving them representation at the area committee meetings, either with or without voting rights. In one area, intergroups elect a G.S.R. and in another, an ex-delegate is appointed as liaison officer to the intergroup.

The majority of central offices seem to have a paid staff and a telephone answering service. Their function is reported as: servicing local groups; keeping up-to-date lists of meeting places; seeing that twelfth-step calls are answered, and dispensing A.A. information. They are in all cases financed by local groups.

Small groups and Loners are helped by supplying tapes of other meetings, lists of speakers available who will travel from group to group and committees who write to all Loners in their areas.

A need was seen for some sort of "A.A. dictionary" because from these discussions, it was obvious that certain

terms ("intergroup," for example) did not mean the same in all areas.

It was pointed out that many times where there is a trouble spot in communications, giving it a chance to work out often proves more satisfactory than an attempt to force a solution immediately.

—Ken K., Reporter

WORKING WITH INTERGROUPS

We can obtain better communications between intergroup and General Service by inviting an intergroup board member to attend regular area meetings; by sending the minutes of area meetings to intergroup, by joining forces on public information and institutional committees and by putting area information in intergroup newsletters.

Central offices are reported to function in two ways by workshop participants:

1. Through a rented office with paid and volunteer help.
2. Through an intergroup board that meets monthly and uses volunteer workers and an answering service. The various committees function well with either organization.

Groups in isolated areas are sometimes adopted by larger groups. They are furnished with meeting lists; personal contact is made by holding conference meetings in isolated areas and by people who travel to their meetings.

Loners are helped by mail and through the efforts of members who travel to see them.

—Aaron K., Reporter

LINK WITH CENTRAL OFFICES

We can obtain broader communications between central offices and general service area committees by: having ex-delegates acting as liaison, through distribution of newsletters and rotating area meetings. Most areas report improved communications where there is activity on the part of delegates and past delegates.

The main problem in the functioning of central offices seems to be in finding enough money for a paid secretary or at least an effective answering service.

The consensus regarding services to small or isolated groups is that they are getting better contacts and communications from central offices whenever they make their existence known.

While there aren't too many Loners, they are helped in every way possible.

—Margie N., Reporter

Public Information

EXTENDING A.A.'s HAND TO THE PUBLIC

The feeling of workshop participants is that cooperation means "working with" and affiliation is "becoming a part of."

They feel that P.I. Committees could better use TV and radio as a means of carrying the message by being more available, by using local people and by working with other agencies. It is noted that program directors will cooperate if material is furnished, that they will offer time and run spot announcements.

Some delegates send announcements to radio stations through G.S.R.'s and another reported conducting an open meeting on TV, without showing any faces.

It is also suggested that advance notice of significant programs be exchanged between the United States and Canada.
—Ted C., Reporter

Some Workshop discussions revealed that the new color TV Public Service Announcement, now completed and ready for distribution, will answer many current public information needs.

A GRAY AREA IN COOPERATION

Participants find that there are difficulties in determining how far we can cooperate with outside agencies without becoming affiliated.

In one area A.A.'s refused to go on the board of a half-way house because of possible affiliation. Another area notes that federal and state agencies offer lucrative jobs to A.A.'s and many members "see the handwriting on the wall." One delegate pointed out that we are "loaded with professional alcoholics" who want to represent A.A. as well as their own agencies.

Other opinions indicated that cooperation never stops with people of good will, but that affiliation starts when an agency tells A.A. what to do. However, it is noted that

good relations should be maintained because A.A. must be available.

Yet another delegate was of the opinion that there are too many alcoholics for A.A. to help them all, so we must cooperate with other agencies, although when we give up any of the autonomy covered by Tradition Four, we are starting on the road to affiliation. However this may not be the fault of the agencies, but rather of the A.A.'s involved who may be counselors on alcoholism committees, or those who participate in fund-raising drives to help other alcoholics.
—Fernand I., Reporter

BETTER USE OF MEDIA

The consensus is that we could and should cooperate with outside agencies whenever possible. Furthermore, we should remember always to maintain our anonymity as A.A. members.

We can give these agencies our thoughts and ideas, in turn accepting their referrals, or we can join them as private citizens but not as A.A. members. Cooperation ceases and affiliation begins if and when we lend the A.A. name to any outside agency.

Much is being done to carry the message through the use of radio and television. Many workshop participants report they are using spot announcements furnished by G.S.O. Others are using local information in various ways because they feel it to be more meaningful. In most cases it seems that radio and TV stations will put on announcements or features if asked and the material is furnished. Response is very good.

It is suggested that those members who have some experience be used to try and get such programs on the air.
—Frank R., Reporter

WORKING WITH OTHER AGENCIES

The consensus of workshop participants is that a public linking of A.A.'s name, or that of a member of A.A. *as such*, with any other organization constitutes affiliation—except where it is clear that A.A.'s participation is limited to making the program available, in connection with the activities of the other organization.
—Joe B., Reporter

Area Highlights

ALA/NW FL—There seems to be more and more interest in Third Legacy work in the Alabama-Northwest Florida area. Public information work is also more prevalent, with regular monthly public meetings held in Birmingham and a radio station continuing a weekly program "Ask an Alcoholic," now in its second year. A central service office has also been established in Birmingham. —*Ted C.*

ARKANSAS — I would like to commend the General Service Conference Committee for the 1969 theme: "Our Group Conscience: Voice of A.A." Each one of us attending this Conference is part of the group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous. If I could express the most predominant feeling in my heart today, it would be a feeling of deep, heartfelt gratitude. —*Neal L.*

BRITISH COLUMBIA—YUKON — The enthusiasm of the present group of G.S.R.'s is very gratifying. Their awareness of responsibility and their willingness to cooperate with each other, as well as with the executive of the area assembly, speaks well for the group conscience. More people seem to be aware that alcoholism is an illness and that A.A. is always available to help. —*Pat O'H.*

CALIFORNIA (Northern Coastal) — One of our best ways of getting together is at our three yearly conferences, guided by our Northern California Council of A.A. New conference areas are picked each year, thereby giving all districts a chance to be host. Al-Anon and Alateen also take an active part in these conferences. This year Young People of A.A. will be with us. —*Ed B.*

CALIFORNIA (Southern) — True group conscience can only be heard if we continuously strive to maintain a line of communication between the group and central office and G.S.O. and then use these lines of communication to accurately inform. For the past year I have made it a practice to attend each monthly meeting of the Los Angeles Central Service Committee, which seems to be generating greater unity in the area. —*Art K.*

COLORADO — The group conscience in our state is good. We have increased the number of state committee members and have scheduled a Stateline Rally for July, which will be in addition to regular quarterly regional meetings and other get-togethers. The number of G.S.R.'s has increased from 16% of groups represented five years ago to 50% now, while the number of groups is up to 20%. —*Evelyn B.*

CONNECTICUT — A halfway house was recently opened in Waterbury. The money for its support comes in from local manufacturers. Supervision from A.A. members works out very well, and there is no problem with the group conscience. At the local prison group, we are notified when inmates are about to be released and volunteers meet them and take them to outside meetings. —*Charlie M.*

DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA — We have a relatively wide variety of meetings in our area. In addition to standard open and closed meetings, we have luncheon, brunch and Sunday afternoon meetings, as well as Beginners and Step

meetings. There are also closed meetings for men and women only, as well as special groups for doctors, psychiatrists and clergymen, and a group on Capitol Hill.

—*Alex B.*

FLORIDA (South) — After an auto accident in Columbia, S.C., my wife was hospitalized, I called local A.A.'s who took me to a meeting where I met scores of friends who sent cards, flowers and made calls on my wife. Most important, they said a prayer for her. It proves out that old saying: "There are no strangers in A.A., only friends who have never met." —*Fred S.*

FLORIDA (North) — A.A. growth has kept pace with the rapid growth in general population. The principle of co-operation without affiliation has been maintained with halfway houses, court programs, prison and hospital group sponsorship, alcoholism councils, industrial programs, educational and welfare programs and state programs, with the group conscience always in evidence. —*Earl M.*

HAWAII — It is illegal in Hawaii to arrest an individual for being drunk. He is rather picked up and taken to either of two hospitals. One is disinclined to treat alcoholics, but the other is in the process of readying a ward, devoted exclusively to the treatment of alcoholism. They have admitted and treated patients as they are brought in.

—*Fran R.*

ILLINOIS (Chicago) — I equate the letters A.A. with two words, Action and Acceptance. Acceptance which must come before action means accepting that you are powerless over alcohol and that without A.A. your life will be unmanageable. Action to me, is the key to the answer why some of us find sobriety and peace of mind while others don't. —*Bill W.*

ILLINOIS (Southern) — Groups are learning how to co-operate with agencies outside of A.A. and we are informing the community through public information meetings that we are willing to work with them to help an alcoholic. We have received many referrals for A.A. help from these groups and in turn call on them when an alcoholic needs hospitalization or additional counseling. —*Dick L.*

INDIANA (Northern) — The Indiana State Committee is concentrating first on improving contacts with institutions having alcoholism programs and A.A. on the outside through personal contact and other means. Second we are trying to improve communications. We publish a newsletter which goes to all G.S.R.'s and serves to keep groups posted on various activities around the state. —*Joe H.*

IOWA — We have members in our group in Spencer who drive more than 40 miles to come to our meetings. However, I have never heard an A.A. complain about the miles driven to attend a meeting. I live 24 miles from my group and have been making this trip regularly for 22 years and there is no question but that I intend to continue for as long as I am able. —*Bob A.*

LOUISIANA — After developing a plan to sell cold drinks to visitors to the penitentiary in order to buy litera-

Area Highlights

ture for the insider group, members had second thoughts and decided that the thing to do was share more freely the literature they had and that each member would spend more time in prayer and meditation. Shortly after outside members donated literature and other material. —Mabel P.

MASSACHUSETTS (Eastern) — Monthly district meetings in our area have been of substantial value as a vehicle for providing frequent and regular communication with the groups. An open public meeting at which Dr. Travis Dancey was featured speaker, was most successful. Of the 600 in attendance, nearly half were judges, doctors, nurses and other professionals we wanted to reach.

—Junior A.

MICHIGAN (Southeastern) — A group of members in an institution were incensed because their chairman was drinking and wouldn't admit it, because it would jeopardize his upcoming parole. It was suggested that they take their own inventory, which they did. The result was that they said nothing and gave him a chance, regarding it as incidental whether he was using A.A. or not. —Joe C.

MICHIGAN (Central) — In our area the group conscience has led us to try to carry the message to all those who deal with the alcoholic—doctors, psychiatrists, law-enforcement officers and others—by starting a public discussion group at which questions can be asked and answered and the availability of A.A. made known. All hospitals, state patrol posts, and institutions also know about A.A.

—Chuck D.

MINNESOTA (Southern) — We are currently trying to establish a good structure for better communication between groups in our area. I have scheduled three assembly meetings to hear my report when I return and letters have been mailed to all groups urging them to elect a G.S.R. and to attend meetings with their area committeemen, in order to improve the line of communication.

—Marvin J.

MISSOURI (Eastern) — Our new Missouri State Alcoholism Program has opened a new era for us. The Eastern area alone has three state hospitals and two mental health centers, all of which have alcoholic treatment units. A.A. has obtained full cooperation with all but one of these facilities and has hopes of forming a better relationship with this one.

—Zora H.

MISSOURI (Western) — For a time we lacked unity throughout the area because we had no satisfactory sharing sessions. Thus we tried round robins. Since 1967, round-robin participants have grown to twelve groups, with meetings every six weeks. They have proven most successful not only for those in attendance but also for our G.S.R.'s. This program has since been expanded.

—Paul S.

NEW YORK (Central) — As an example of group conscience in our area, a number of groups are subsidizing their G.S.R.'s in whole or in part to cover travel expenses to the monthly G.S.R. meeting. Thus, any qualified member can afford to take the job; the group is more inclined

to listen to his report, and new members are appraised of our responsibility at the service level.

—Ada W.

NEW YORK (Southeast) — The greatest help we have found in explaining service is through the latest filmstrip. It has been shown at least once a week and many times twice a week since the beginning of the year. It anticipates most questions, but we try to have the G.S.R. and committeeman with us to answer questions. It makes their job easier and helps them become more active.

—George S.

NEVADA — General Service activities have grown rapidly during the past few years. This is due to activity of delegates, words of wisdom from older members, and the G.S.R.'s who have carried the message back to the groups. We have problems of distance, but the unity in our area is good. We are trying to improve the group conscience by emphasizing membership in a home group.

—Bob R.

NEW JERSEY (Northern) — Our General Service Committee meets monthly except for July and August. The striking thing about them is the sincerity and dedication of the G.S.R.'s. Discussions involve such things as knowledge and communications, liaison with intergroup, anonymity breaks, finances and annual meetings. Currently we are planning to assume P.I. activities for the Intergroup.

—Ed K.

NORTH CAROLINA — We planned our first state G.S.R. assembly for a weekend—with good surroundings, discussions, business meetings, and speaker meetings. Wives were also invited, but not to attend business meetings. The response was terrific, with 64 members at the first, and 89 at the second, plus delegates and committee. It has done more to further unity than anything else.

—Wade J.

NOVA SCOTIA, NEWFOUNDLAND, LABRADOR — An Atlantic Provinces convention is in the works in our area. Because of the time and distance factor, it is difficult to be in constant touch with committeemen and G.S.R.'s. For that reason we send out newsletters from time to time to G.S.R.'s and committeemen. This contains a list of items of general and area interest.

—Gordon F.

OHIO (Central and Southeast) — Our most successful recent event was a 24-hour Alkathon, from noon, Dec. 24 to noon, Dec. 25. Flyers were mailed well in advance to all area secretaries. Radio, television and newspaper briefs announced the event. There were 24 one-hour meetings, one of which was led by a local minister who helped to found A.A. in Columbus. Attendance was 597.

—Marie L.

OHIO (Northeast) — In our district, we have 29 groups, with a good intergroup council. Once a month we meet along with an alcoholism committee, which is made up of seven members — two doctors, one judge, three personnel directors, an alcohol program director and myself. We contact newspapers, radio and TV stations, doctors, hospitals and industry.

—John L.

Area Highlights

OKLAHOMA — Through a strong state organization we have developed a history of good sound annual state conferences at which we have more than one thousand in attendance. Six districts in the state hold regular quarterly meetings and are always well prepared for reporting on their activities at quarterly state committee meetings. One district even has its own annual conference. —*Bob B.*

ONTARIO (East) — In one district of my area there was a proposal to divide the district. This caused concern because some of the groups would be left in a vulnerable position—cut off from active participation in public information, institutional and conference planning work. The proposal was voted on at a district meeting and defeated—the group conscience spoke and unity was strengthened. —*Ed A.*

ONTARIO (Northeast) — Presently we are working very successfully with courts and law-enforcement officers. In order to help the “revolving door alcoholic,” we have set up a committee and all contacts are made through its chairman; he has been made acquainted with the probation officers, judges, family courts, wardens and the chief of police. It has been helpful to us, having some of these as members of A.A. —*Maurice L.*

ONTARIO (Northwestern) — As a Conference area we are only three years old, and have a lot to learn. But we are confident in the knowledge that we can draw on the strength and experience of the older and established areas throughout the continent. As we suffer our growing pains we will be leaning heavily upon you in preparation for the day when we, too, can share in the extension of the A.A. message. —*Carl LeB.*

PENNSYLVANIA (Eastern) — We have 13 areas made up of 150 groups with about 5000 members. Our area committeemen hold area meetings once a month and our state committee meets four times a year. Delegate and state chairman have an area roundup meeting at least once a year in each area, and an annual three-day state conference which attracts 500 persons. —*Monroe B.*

PENNSYLVANIA (Western) — Interest in alcoholism has been stimulated by the efforts of the University of Pittsburgh and a local alcoholism committee through a series of six lectures on such subjects as: “Alcoholism in America”; “Current Issues in Alcoholism”; “A Medical Approach to Alcoholism,” and “The Principles of a Community Approach to Alcohol Rehabilitation.” —*Henry C.*

TEXAS (Northeast) — Several years ago my group was willed property which had been rented for a club. This was a great temptation, as the property was valuable and we could have a fine club. We toyed with the idea, rationalized that we could do a great deal with it rather than have it revert to distant relatives. However, the group conscience prevailed and we turned it down. —*Ken J.*

TEXAS (Southeast) — The area Intergroup Association helped form an inter-agency group with other agencies to muster planning and the pooling of resources for work on alcoholism as a community problem. A main objective was

detoxification center which is now being established along with a system of nearby 30-day, 60-day, 90-day and longer stay half-way houses, all of which will have provisions for A.A. meetings and sponsorship. —*Ina Lee C.*

UTAH — The prospect of receiving funds from outside sources to support the Central Office at Salt Lake created great dissension among members who felt it necessary to accept money in order to keep the office open and those who felt we should support it ourselves. Advice was sought from New York and a meeting held at which members voted to refuse the money. The most wonderful thing was the unity and understanding developed through the group conscience. —*Shorty B.*

VIRGINIA — No form of contribution to G.S.O. serves such a dual purpose as an “In Memoriam Gift.” The card that G.S.O. sends out to the bereaved announcing the name of the giver is deeply appreciated. One friend told me that of all the flowers, cards, letters received she was most deeply touched by the G.S.O. cards showing the contributions of A.A. friends. —*Mac B.*

WASHINGTON — The correct expression of the group conscience in regard to self-support and the worth of Tradition Seven lends credibility to the oft-repeated principle that “there are no dues or fees for A.A. membership,” that money is not the all-important matter in A.A., and that we are one organization that turns down gifts of money or other valuables. —*Al D.*

WEST VIRGINIA — The general condition of A.A. in our state is on the upgrade, due to the hard work and efforts of the state committee and G.S.R.’s who are trying to generate more enthusiasm and support for G.S.O., both by activity and financial support. Still there is a great deal of work to be done in orienting our hospitals and institutions to A.A. —*Con H.*

WISCONSIN (Southern) — The group conscience has directed us very well in my area in trying to help new members. In both open and closed meetings the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions are discussed very thoroughly. A good supply of Conference-approved literature is always on hand, and everyone is encouraged to read it. All members are also asked to take part in discussions. —*Martin T.*

CONFERENCE (from p. 9)

It’s proper or square name is “The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.” As you know, it publishes the “official” A.A. monthly magazine, The A.A. Grapevine.

The Grapevine is *editorially independent* and is, literally, “The Voice of A.A.” And then, there’s G.S.O.

G.S.O. is a place—not an organization. Specifically, it is an office. It houses A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine. It is run by A.A.W.S.; the Grapevine, in effect, subleases space from A.A.W.S.

To sum up: The Board formulates policy; the Conference approves policy, and G.S.O. implements policy.

—*Bob H., General Manager
A.A. World Services, Inc.*

Activities Shared by G.S.O. Staff

Each staff member has specific responsibilities. However, she does not work alone but through the "group conscience" of the entire staff.

Our primary service is correspondence. Thus we receive experience from groups, central offices, individual members, Loners, and others. This experience is, in turn, shared with others.

Each staff member is responsible for correspondence in the geographic areas to which she is assigned. In addition, each has a specific service assignment, such as, Institutions, Internationalists, Overseas, and Public Information, among others.

There are also a few standard responsibilities each staff member must assume, no matter what her assignment. Correspondence, for instance, is circularized for all to read. Thus staff members are kept up to date on what is happening in and around A.A.

There is also constant evaluation of the many newsletters, publications, reports, and other materials received from central service offices, local P.I.C.'s, prisons, and other agencies in the field of alcoholism which communicate with G.S.O.

In addition, each staff member serves as secretary of a Trustees' committee and a Conference committee, assuming responsibility for notices, agendas, and minutes of meetings.

Staff members meet weekly to share experience and to give each other guidance on unusual problems, report on trips to areas, discuss new trends in A.A., and to receive progress reports on current projects.

—Waneta N.
Staff Coordinator

MORE COMMITTEE MEMBERS

The past year has revealed a continuous flow of A.A. activity on the part of members in all Conference areas. One indication of this is the fact that there are some 1,400 committee members on the G.S.O. mailing list, an increase of 200 from 1968.

When the first Conference met in 1951, there were 37 delegates. At the 1969 Conference there are 90 whose continuing action helps to insure A.A.'s survival.

In accordance with a recent Conference recommendation that G.S.R.'s receive the group mailing from G.S.O., about 75% of the groups in the U.S. and Canada comply.

The Conference secretary is in touch with delegates, committee members and G.S.R.'s during the year on all matters pertaining to the Conference. As soon as G.S.O. is notified of the election of a General Service Conference Committee officer or committee member, he or she is placed on the mailing list and a Conference Kit is sent.

The Conference secretary prepares the *Quarterly Report* which gives the highlights of the General Service Board and Committee meetings held during the year and mails it to delegates and committee members.

She is responsible for preparation of the annual meeting each year, subject to approval of the vice chairman of the General Service Conference. She works closely with the Agenda/Admissions Committee where the actual planning starts. The committee meets during the Conference, and ideas and thoughts are shared throughout the year. Members reviewed all 1969 Conference agenda subjects and explored the current admissions procedures.

—Beth K.
Conference Secretary

CENTRAL OFFICES SERVE NEEDS

There are some 200 A.A. central (or intergroup) offices and committees around the world. They serve a very vital A.A. purpose in the areas in which they are located.

G.S.O. has these offices on the mailing list and also has a special bulletin for them which is mailed quarterly. There are problems in regard to this bulletin. Suggested by the Conference, its prime purpose is to provide a sharing of experience between offices. But material for it has been very scarce. We feel this is partly due to the very active and busy lives of the central (or intergroup) A.A.'s, both paid and volunteers, in handling twelfth-step calls.

And yet, we do feel there is much to be gained from "sharing" by these service centers. At this time we are trying to find a more satisfactory method. Will you please help us? Maybe you could contact the central offices in your area and see how we can more effectively serve them.

It is our hope that your area committee has a liaison with these offices. We know it will help much for them to share in your area experience and your committee will be richer for sharing their activities, as they are such an active part of A.A. service in your area.

Also, may we suggest a review of the Guidelines on Central Offices? Perhaps they will enable you to assist when a new central committee or office is being formed.

—Hazel R.
Central Offices

PUBLISHING ACTIVITIES UP

A.A.W.S. is a membership corporation and is responsible for the employment of G.S.O. personnel, for preparing and controlling the operating budget, and for publishing and distributing all Conference-approved books and pamphlets.

G.S.O.'s administrative group is made up of the chairman of General Services, the controller, staff members, and the other supervisors of departments. There are 43 full-time employees and eight part time. (This is exclusive of the Grapevine's personnel.)

PUBLISHING: Sales of A.A. literature continued to increase and so reflect the growth of A.A. In 1968 sales were up 4.9% from 1967. After paying its own share of overhead, the publishing operation contributed \$65,000 in support of other services.

ACCOUNTING: Under the direction of Charles Columbia, the department processed 14,650 orders and 17,920 contribution remittances during 1968. Payrolls were also prepared, bills processed and paid, books kept, statistics maintained and analyses made of literature costs and payroll comparisons.

CLERICAL/STENO: Supervised by Kleina Jones and Madeline Whitlock, the department employs 14 girls, six of whom are secretaries and handle transcription of all correspondence and minutes. Three others work in a file unit. There is also a Spanish translator, a receptionist, a switchboard operator and a senior clerk.

SHIPPING: The year 1968 was another of greatly increased activity for Shipping. Al Cryan supervises seven full-time and six part-time employees. This year the department handled nearly 300,000 pieces of incoming and outgoing mail, including inquiries, group letters, contributions, and orders for books and pamphlets.

WORLD SERVICE MEETING SET

The 18th General Service Conference approved the proposal for a World Service Meeting to be held in New York in the fall of 1969. Eleven countries and one zone have been invited to elect delegates to attend this meeting.

The World Service Planning Committee has been meeting regularly since last year to discuss plans and agenda for the meeting. As it stands, the agenda for the sessions will be separated into four categories for presentation and discussion: (1) Structure, (2) Finance, (3) Publishing, and (4) Services.

These sessions will be divided into three parts: (1) Presentation of G.S.O. experience, (2) Small roundtable discussions, and (3) Delegates' report on their experience. Theme of the meeting will be "Our Common Welfare Should Come First."

—Bob H., Chairman

ARCHIVES: Nell Wing supervises the filing and indexing of all our books, pamphlets, tapes, reports and other items. She also serves as Bill's secretary, and production editor of the 3 editions of *Box 4-5-9*.

RECORDS: Under the direction of Rose Failla, the department set up records for 1,625 new groups and recorded some 9,150 changes of addresses in 1968. The compilation of four directories involved the accurate listing of more than 14,000 groups.

—Bob H., Chairman
A.A. World Services, Inc.

LITERATURE DISTRIBUTED - 1968

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	41,915
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Reg. Edition)	14,791
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (Gift Edition)	5,296
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	4,783
30th Anniversary Book - A.A./30	582
A.A. Way of Life	15,160
Alcoholics Anonymous - Spanish Edition	1,446
Total	83,973

PAMPHLETS

This is A.A.	147,175
A.A. - 44 Questions and Answers	128,632
Is A.A. For You?	181,497
Young People and A.A.	59,496
A.A. for the Woman	27,198
A.A. for the Woman - New Edition (New)	32,580
Alcoholism The Illness	72,828
The Alcoholic Husband	78,480
The Alcoholic Wife	58,080
Memo to an Inmate	23,878
Sedatives, Stimulants and the Alcoholic	72,774
The Jack Alexander Article - About A.A.	47,305
The Fortune Story About A.A.	34,823
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	46,120
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	38,403
What Happened to Joe	93,127
It Happened to Alice (New)	19,534
The A.A. Group	29,432
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	25,998
Inside A.A.	25,003
The G.S.R.	26,414
The Third Legacy Manual & Twelve Concepts	2,763
A.A. and the Medical Profession	30,265
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	23,307
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	29,049
A.A. In Prisons	11,832
A.A. In Hospitals	15,430
The Fellowship of A.A.	57,882
A.A. In Your Community	113,557
Foreign Translations	66,638
Total	1,619,500

MISCELLANEOUS

Tapes of A.A. Talks	320
Wallet Cards - 2 Fold	264,134
Wallet Cards - "I Am Responsible"	46,784
Parchment Scrolls	2,012
How It Works	76,991
Newcomers' Meeting Kit	1,373
Group Handbook	1,950

SERVICE TOOLS AVAILABLE

The primary responsibility of all employees at G.S.O. is to "share" the thousands of miracles of recovery, unity, and service available here, so that the A.A. message will reach still-suffering alcoholics and enrich the lives of those in A.A. today.

Some 1,650 new groups were added to G.S.O.'s mailing list last year. Each received complimentary literature and other material.

Box 4-5-9, a bulletin sharing A.A. news around the world, is compiled and mailed every other month to the G.S.O. mailing list. Through *Box 4-5-9*, A.A.'s are kept informed of new services, new literature, new trends in A.A., the growth and development of A.A. around the world, conferences and conventions and roundups, new and old A.A. problems and the overall thinking and experience concerning them, current G.S.O. activities, and as many of the shared experiences from letters as space allows. A G.S.R. column is included each issue and response has been gratifying. There are also special announcements which may be read to the group. *Box 4-5-9* is also distributed in French and Spanish.

The *World Directory* is in two parts this year, *Part I* covers the United States and Canada, while *Part II* lists A.A. groups in all other areas.

Guidelines contain suggestions and shared experience in specific A.A. service areas where problems can be avoided if the Traditions and previous experience are reviewed.

Also available from G.S.O. are filmstrips, films and tapes, which are listed on literature order blanks.

—Hazel R.
Service Coordinator

KEEPING PUBLIC INFORMED

The General Service Office received 5,981 inquiries in 1968. They came from students, teachers, nurses, doctors, clergymen and many others seeking information about A.A. and alcoholism.

In addition, our two professional exhibits were shown at meetings and conventions throughout the country. They were manned by volunteers who provided visitors with information and literature about A.A. The office received many inquiries as a result of these showings.

In 1968 we received 2,147 press clippings from the United States and Canada. Among these were 39 anonymity

breaks. The newspaper, the delegate and the individual A.A. member were sent letters each time. In many cases we received thoughtful replies to these communications.

The clippings attest to the strong work of local Public Information Committees, groups and members in keeping the public informed about A.A. They also indicate that the public image of A.A. is one about which any member can feel satisfaction.

We also provided service and material in many other ways—to legal and law-enforcement agencies which have instituted special alcoholism programs; to doctors, psychologists and scientists who conduct educational programs in their professions; and to industrial and labor representatives who have begun programs for alcoholic employees, as well as to newspapers, radio and television programs which are interested in A.A. and alcoholism.

—Cora Louise B.
Information Services

1539 INSTITUTION GROUPS

In 1969 we have 648 registered hospital groups with an approximate membership of 16,000 and 891 prison groups with 35,000 members. There are some 350 institutional sponsors registered and 102 Institutions Committees.

Services to institutional groups include yearly distribution of A.A. institutional directories, which enables groups to correspond with each other and exchange experiences. Complimentary literature is also distributed to new groups as well as to those which are unable to meet their own needs. In addition, these groups receive the *World Directory*, *Box 4-5-9*, and the *Institutions Bulletin*.

Personal correspondence shares our A.A. experiences with groups, individual members, administrators, sponsors, and others who want to know more about the A.A. help available for inmates and patients.

A tabulation of the 1968 questionnaire sent to all institutional groups indicates that groups on the "inside" are as a whole able to operate within the framework of the Traditions in much the same way as groups on the outside.

Problems faced by institutional groups include the fact that many hospital and prison administrators tend to lump alcoholism with other illnesses. Thus the mentally disturbed and the narcotic addict are often referred to A.A. because it seems to be the only available source of help. Another problem is in supplying literature to these groups, although there is less difficulty where there is an active institutions committee. There is also an increasing need for visual aids which are descriptive of the A.A. program.

—Ann M., Institutions

PROBLEMS OVERSEAS THE SAME

The problems of A.A. groups and members outside the U.S. and Canada are basically the same as they are here. This was clearly revealed from a questionnaire sent to 16 countries.

Their most important problems: lack of unity; difficulty in financing General Service and central offices; apathy toward service by A.A.'s, and slow growth of A.A. due to little or no public information and literature distribution.

Still, A.A. is doing very well and growing at a slow but steady pace around the world.

South Africa now has the Big Book on tape and is also working on a tape library.

Australia is celebrating its 21st Anniversary this year.

South Vietnam, Thailand, and Japan report new and re-activated groups of service personnel.

India and Ceylon report very active groups in Bombay, Calcutta, and Colombo.

Italy reports a new group in Milan, but overall growth in that country is painfully slow.

Iceland has translated but not yet printed the Big Book.

Great Britain has an annual General Service Conference. There has been increased activity in public information, with several TV programs being shown, as well as radio programs and public meetings.

Germany, Belgium, and Switzerland have also found public meetings an effective way to carry the message. Such meetings are well attended by doctors, nurses, social workers, clergy, and other professionals.

—Midge M.
Overseas (Except Spanish)

1500 SPANISH-SPEAKING GROUPS

There are some 1,500 A.A. groups throughout the Spanish-speaking world registered with G.S.O. However, there may be many more. We recently heard, for instance, that there are fourteen groups in Buenos Aires, although we only have two listed in the *World Directory*.

We are sure, however, that there is tremendous growth of A.A. in Spanish-speaking countries, especially in the Central American region. For example, in El Salvador, a country of three million people, there are 20,000 A.A. members. Furthermore, they travel from country to country by bus. Recently 60 of them went to Panama to carry the

message. As the local group was not very active at the time, six decided to stay and work with them.

There are 25 central offices in the Latin countries. They service groups with literature, directories and twelfth-step work. There are also four Literature Distribution Centers in Latin America and one General Service Office in Colombia, which services all of South America. They print the Big Book in Spanish, along with 15 pamphlets, including "What Happened to Joe."

—Mary Ellen U.
Spanish-speaking areas

SEAMEN FEEL A.A. RESPONSIBILITY

The 350 Internationalists listed at G.S.O. are seamen who maintain their sobriety on ships where there are no A.A. groups or members nearby. They receive alternately each month copies of the *Round Robin* and *Box 4-5-9*.

Internationalists carry A.A.'s message to every port of call, providing strength and encouragement to far-away groups by their visits, their gifts of literature and their bringing A.A. news.

A new project being worked on by the members themselves is a listing of A.A. contacts in ports, and the HAM radio group functions daily to provide A.A. contact to those in the ships' radio rooms.

Their feeling of responsibility for the work that is going on at G.S.O. and in A.A. throughout the world is truly gratifying.

—Ann M.
Internationalists

LONERS LIKE TO SHARE

In 1947 Pat O'F. wrote a letter from South Africa to G.S.O. The letter said: "Periodically, once a month when I get paid I have a drinking bout. Why I do this I don't know, but I want to stop completely as these blackouts are jeopardizing my religion, as well as causing untold suffering to people who love me. I am twenty-five years of age and want to get married. Would you please help me before it is too late?"

Pat received his help shortly in the form of a letter along with some A.A. literature. As there were no groups available, it was suggested that he practice the principles of A.A. to stop drinking and correspond with G.S.O. and other A.A.'s. Pat recently celebrated his 21st A.A. anniversary and today there are more than 100 groups in South Africa.

(continued on p. 30)

A.A.'s 35th AT MIAMI BEACH

A.A.'s 35th Anniversary year will be celebrated with an International A.A. Convention at Miami Beach, Florida, July 3rd, 4th and 5th, 1970. Plans are progressing and it promises to be a memorable get-together for A.A.'s and their families throughout the world.

The big meetings, in which Bill and Lois will participate, are to be held in the spectacular Convention Hall. The Fontainebleau Hotel will serve as A.A. headquarters. Large, daytime panel meetings, alkathons, and workshops will be held there.

The Eden Roc Hotel will be headquarters for Al-Anon.

The convention theme is "Unity." The first registration and housing forms will be mailed from G.S.O. on October 15, 1969. Registration fee is \$6, with tickets for the opening dance and show, \$4. Housing will be assigned on a first-come, first-served basis.

—Bob H.
Convention Chairman

Fred S., delegate from the South Florida area, and co-chairman for the Host Committee of the 1970 Convention, reported on their activities for the 35th Anniversary Convention. He said the Convention Hall seats 18,000; many eating places are available (hotel coffee shops are open all night and prices are reasonable); all hotels, restaurants and Convention Hall are air-conditioned.

Opening night (Thursday) will have two dance bands and for the Big Show (closing night, Sunday), six or seven well-known performers will be on hand to entertain.

What to wear and when? Everyone goes around in sport clothes during the day. Usually dress for dinner, men with light coats and gals with sweaters.

LONERS (continued from p. 29)

Many Loners like to write and are happy to share their experience with G.S.O. and with other Loners. They are also put in touch with Loner Sponsors, so they have a special A.A. pen-pal. A Loner Sponsor is a group member who has volunteered for this special form of twelfth-step work. All possible encouragement is given to Loners to form a group. Today, it would be impossible to count the hundreds of groups started through the zeal of Lone Members.

—Midge M.
Lone Members

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION

4-1-69

<i>United States</i>	43,981
<i>Canada</i>	6,287
<i>U.S. Possessions</i>	108
<i>All Foreign</i>	825

GV REACHES 52,000

Grapevine circulation climbed to 52,000 in 1968 from 49,000 at the end of 1967. This was for subscriptions only. Single sales of each issue generally run between 1,500 and 2,000 extra.

In October, a special issue about alcohol, alcoholism, and A.A., was quickly exhausted, and for the first time in its history the Grapevine went back to press with an order of 5,000. These copies were widely distributed among members of the medical profession.

A committee was appointed by the corporate board to explore the Grapevine structure. The committee met with the board in February and recommended that a full-time editor would be advisable. Jack M., present full-time production manager, was then appointed editor of the Grapevine, effective March 1, 1969.

Reception of the Grapevine by the Fellowship has been highly favorable. The number and quality of manuscripts that come, unsolicited, across our desk is heartwarming. Sixty percent of the contents of any given issue derive from these unsolicited manuscripts. The remaining forty percent of the issue comes from long-time A.A. contributors, articles written on assignment, and from friends of A.A. who are experts or professionals in fields allied with alcoholism.

Although all 1969 Calendar orders were filled through the October 15 deadline, approximately 2,000 Calendar orders were refunded or returned. We will order 15,000 of the 1970 Calendar this year.

Material in the October issue will salute the World Meeting to be held in New York at that time. We are seeking estimates on a cartoon or humor book of reprints from the GV, tentatively titled "Best Cartoons from the Grapevine" or "Best Grapevine Humor," to be offered at the 1970 International Convention.

—Jack M., *Editor*
—Paula C., *Managing Editor*

(As of the May 1969 issue, circulation is 53,400)

Questions and Answers

1. Why is it "I am Responsible" instead of "We are Responsible?" Many A.A.'s are disturbed by the "I."
 - A. The "I" won out on the basis that the individual could not then easily evade or minimize his own responsibility, which might be the case if the emphasis was placed on "we." Also each A.A. speaks for himself.
2. Can't we abolish the word "drunkalog" from the A.A. vocabulary?
 - A. There is no way to prevent people from using it, nor can the Conference put any prohibition on its use, since this falls in the area of an individual's rights and group autonomy.
3. If the word "unmanageable" in the First Step was replaced with the phrase "difficult to manage," would it eliminate one of the objections some high-bottom drunks have about joining A.A.?
 - A. After discussion delegates decided that the wording should remain as it is.
4. Many who have slips don't make it back. Why don't we have literature for them?
 - A. A new pamphlet, "How We Stay Sober in A.A.," is now being considered for this purpose, among others.
5. Is a group steering committee necessary?
 - A. This depends on group size and organization. Small groups may not need one. See "The A.A. Group."
6. Does the Grapevine sell its mailing list?
 - A. No, and it would not consider doing so. The anonymity of every subscriber is very carefully guarded.
7. We were given to understand that our vote for a regional trustee candidate would be wasted because our candidate works for an outside agency and a small but very vocal group was opposed to this.
 - A. In 1966 the Conference recommended that "An A.A. member professionally employed in the field of alcoholism should not be excluded from service on the General Service Board, solely for that reason, but it is desirable that the Board and its Nominating Committee maintain the guardianship of Alcoholics Anonymous on a nonprofessional level."
8. How should A.A. prepare for court rulings that alcoholism is an illness for which a person cannot be imprisoned?
 - A. There is a concern with what we can do and the possibility that outside agencies might expect more from A.A. than they should. Information should be sent out, describing what A.A. can and cannot do and offering full cooperation within these limits.
9. What is the possibility about a filmstrip covering a delegate's experience at the annual Conference?
 - A. This is an interesting idea that should be further investigated. It will be brought up for discussion at future meetings.
10. How are halfway houses financed?
 - A. Since there is no such thing as an A.A. halfway house, staffing, financing and administration are not A.A.'s concern or responsibility, and no opinion can be given.
11. Some groups conduct money raffles. How do members who object to this practice handle it?
 - A. If there is no clearcut violation of the A.A. Tradition, it would seem to depend on the group conscience.
12. Can we use names and numbers listed in the World Directory for those out of institutions who ask for contacts in other cities?
 - A. Delegates felt it is best when permission is received in advance. Some areas have a list of willing sponsors in various cities, in others the name of the sponsor is given to the parole officer who then informs the former inmate, and in others the secretary of the inmate group writes to the outside group about the prisoner who is soon to be released. This provides better sponsorship.
13. Are all members attending the World Service Meeting in October, 1969 natives of the countries concerned?
 - A. They are required to be legal citizens of the countries they represent, but not native born.
14. Is A.A. active in Russia?
 - A. We don't know of any, but there is limited A.A. activity in Poland, Hungary and Yugoslavia.

(continued from p. 31)

15. Should A.A. groups be given a financial report by the treasurer?

A. Most groups receive such a report quarterly.

16. A.A. prison group asks if it can sell soft drinks to other prisoners without violating the Traditions.

A. Even though the money would be used to buy literature, it would violate the Traditions, since it would put A.A. into business. This points up the need of outside A.A.'s to see that the needs of those on the inside are met.

17. How are regional trustees compensated?

A. The only "compensation" received by *any* trustee is for travel and expenses in coming to New York to attend quarterly G.S.B. meetings.

18. What is G.S.O.'s opinion on weekend retreats which emphasize only the spiritual side of the program?

A. Delegates noted that there are many kinds of retreats, religious and otherwise, but that they are essentially private and closed affairs which should not bear the A.A. label. See page 14 of "Cooperation But Not Affiliation."

19. What can we call our quarterly state conferences to avoid confusion with the G.S. Annual Conference Meeting?

A. The annual meeting of delegates is called the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference to distinguish it from smaller area gatherings. Convention and roundup are terms often used in the areas. Assembly means an official meeting of the Area Committee and G.S.R.'s. Placing the name of the state or area in front of the word conference or convention localizes the title so that there is no confusion with the annual meeting of the General Service Conference.

20. Can G.S.O. remind local groups that they can help support local offices through purchase of literature when they have it available?

A. This will be noted in a future issue of *Box 4-5-9*. However, central offices themselves are in a better position to let their own groups know what they have available.

21. Is the Grapevine planning to produce a Christmas card for A.A. members?

A. No, but it will be considered.

22. What can be done to change a state law whereby a person treated for alcoholism has his driver's license canceled for at least one year?

A. We can't as A.A. members influence legislature to have laws changed, although we can act as individuals. The National Council on Alcoholism might be helpful in this area.

23. How can we go about creating more enthusiasm and contributions for G.S.O. among older members?

A. The G.S.O. filmstrip is one means. This subject is on the Conference agenda for 1970.

24. Can a delegate who has completed his term move to a different state and return as delegate from there?

A. Delegates unanimously reaffirmed previous conference action limiting the term of delegate to one two-year term, with the exception of an alternate who, after filling one year of the delegate's term, may be elected to serve his own two-year term.

25. Is there any information about court programs or relations between local institutional committees and judges?

A. Guidelines are available on Court Programs.

26. A minister requested that an A.A. member speak from the pulpit about A.A. and that 18 or 20 other A.A. members take up the collection. Is this against our Eleventh Tradition?

A. Though a matter for local decision, it is felt that this could cause confusion in the public mind regarding A.A.'s tradition of non-affiliation and perhaps self-support.

27. Is there any reason why G.S.O. could not be moved out of the high rent New York area?

A. Leaving New York would pose many problems. G.S.O. is looking for less expensive quarters now.

28. Should an A.A. member who is also a member of Schizophrenics Anonymous be barred from speaking at A.A. meetings?

A. An A.A. member is entitled to speak at meetings, no matter what else he belongs to. If his talk is devoted to S.A., he probably wouldn't be asked to speak again, as A.A. meetings are for sharing by alcoholics.

Dr. Norris Reports on G.S.B. Activities

Once again it is my privilege to report to you on the state of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous which is, in your Board's opinion, in excellent shape. We are concerned that group contributions still are substantially below the cost of group services, but you will be hearing more about this from Bob Morse. I would like to touch briefly on some of the policies established by the Board during the past year.

Closer Contact With Trustees Planned

For some time now we have been trying to find a way to bring your trustees into closer contact with the Fellowship. We believe this can be done by taking advantage of the increasing numbers of state and area conferences, conventions and assemblies. Beginning now, any such meeting can bring its regional trustee to participate in its sessions by paying only half of his expenses; the board will pay the other half, up to a maximum of \$250 per regional trustee per year.

We are planning on making another film featuring Bill. This will be, in effect, a sequel to "Bill's Own Story." In it Bill will talk about the Traditions, how they came into being, why they are important and what they mean to the future of A.A. The film will probably be previewed at next year's conference, then shown in Miami during the International Convention.

You may recall that last year, I spoke to you about our intended participation in the 28th International Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism held in Washington, D.C. last September. I am happy to be able to report to you now that this participation was most successful. As a result of it, many professionals in the field of alcoholism learned for the first time just how A.A. can help with the sick alcoholic.

Survey Results Presented

This Congress also served as a setting from which we were able to present the results of our first continent-wide, broad-scale survey of our own members who attend A.A. meetings. These survey results have been widely publicized and, as a matter of fact, are still appearing in the press some seven months later.

Last year Panel 18 delegates, together with their associates on Panel 17, approved a proposal to hold A.A.'s first World Service Meeting this coming October. You will hear more of this later; in fact, you will shortly be electing your own delegates to attend this historic meeting. The theme of it will be "Our Common Welfare." As you know, this comes from our First or Unity Tradition.

"Unity" will likewise be the theme of our 35th Anniversary International Convention in Miami Beach in 1970. I hope you will think it as important as we do, for it speaks to us of the future. And it is unity which assures our future.

Sometimes it seems to me that we concentrate too much on the "now." We think too often, I suspect, of A.A. as "ours," when perhaps we should remember that it is "theirs" too. For "they" are the legions of alcoholics yet to come.

"...Ours To Give Away"

We must all remember that A.A. is ours to give away — to pass on — and that unless we do, we will lose it. Other generations will need A.A. as we need it now. So with the help of God, we must pass our Fellowship along, unimpaired and indivisible. A.A. unity today becomes, in a very real sense, our sober pledge to the future.

—Dr. John L. Norris, Chairman

POLICY COMMITTEE

The Policy Committee met in July and October of 1968 and in January of 1969 on the Sunday before the General Service Board Meetings.

All trustees, directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs are invited to attend, as well as committee members of the Public Information, Literature and International Committees.

A "Town Hall Meeting" format is used with from 35-40 present, which provides a wealth of experience to clarify our A.A. thinking and forms the basis for recommendations to the Board.

Reports are received from A.A.W.S., Grapevine, Public Information and International Committees, regional trustees and the Conference secretary. The committee discusses A.A. policy and makes recommendations to the Board.

As recommended by the 1965 Conference, the chairman in January drew Panel 19 delegates by geographical lot for Conference Committees.

At the April meeting, during the Conference, the Conference Advisory Actions are reviewed.

(cont'd on p. 34)

POLICY (from p. 33)

Following are some of the subjects reviewed by the Policy Committee during the past year and their decisions concerning them:

- A. Approved agenda subjects and theme for the annual Conference.
- B. Recommended to the Board that:
 1. The dates for the World Service Meeting be October 9-11, 1969, and that the theme, "Our Common Welfare Should Come First," be approved.
 2. October 15, 1969, be the date for the first mailing of registration and housing forms for the 1970 Convention and that the theme, "Unity," be approved.
 3. The International Committee, subcommittee of the Policy Committee, become a full Committee of the Board.
 4. Recommended to the Board the following titles for the two sections of the *World Directory*:
 - a. Part I for the United States and Canada
 - b. Part II is everything outside of the U.S. and Canada
- C. Disapproved a suggestion from an area delegate that the First Step be changed.

---Tom B., Chairman

P.I. COMMITTEE

During the past year the Public Information Committee worked in a variety of ways to help carry the A.A. message of recovery and to extend the hand of A.A. by providing information to the public.

The survey of A.A. membership in the United States and Canada was conducted and results were released at a press conference in Washington during the International Congress on Alcohol and Alcoholism. As a result, we received wide coverage in the press, radio, and television.

During the past year a number of national publications have carried important articles on alcoholism in which A.A. was mentioned favorably. Among them: *U.S. News & World Report*; *Look*; *Fortune*; *Dun's Review*; *Christian Herald*; *Real Story*; *Business Week*, and *Business Management*.

Information was furnished to the Bell Telephone Company for a film on alcoholism, to the Industrial Conference Board for a bulletin, and to the publication, *Jobs Overseas*, among others. A press release was sent out on the new comic pamphlet, "It Happened to Alice."

In addition, P.I. members prepared an outline for stimulating activities aimed at hard-to-reach alcoholics and

guidelines for A.A. cooperation during Alcoholism Information Month. A color TV public service announcement was also completed and will be ready for distribution in the early summer.

There are many projects now in the works involving news stories, articles and pamphlets. Among the most important are the plans now taking shape for public information activities at the 35th Anniversary International Convention in Miami Beach in 1970.

Another project in the planning stage is a proposal for a survey on "What the Public Thinks of A.A.," which would find the most common misconceptions about A.A. on the part of the general public. We are also looking for better ways to reach industry as well as ways to carry the A.A. message to the college campus.

---Bayard P., Jr., Chairman

FINANCE & BUDGETARY COMMITTEE

I am pleased to say that, overall, the financial picture for 1968 was satisfactory. Sales for the year were good with sales of *old* products providing a substantial increase in income of \$39,045 or 11.5%. However, that increase was offset to a considerable extent by a decrease of \$21,522 in the income from the sale of *new* products ("The A.A. Way of Life" and "What Happened to Joe") resulting in an increase in net sales income of \$18,183 over 1967. A drop in sales of new products is a normal occurrence and this decline was fully anticipated. *Group contributions* during the year were quite satisfactory, exceeding the 1967 total by \$19,784 or \$1,215 more than forecast. *General Service Organization expenses* for the year were higher but the increase fortunately was modest, amounting to less than 1½% of the budgeted amount.

The 1969 G.S.O. budget has been reviewed by the committee and approved. *Sales* are expected to show a normal average increase of 3.4%. However, the *expenses* of the publishing operation have been budgeted 7.3% higher than the actual expenses for 1968. This higher rate of increase is a matter of some concern, although quite typical of expense trends in these inflationary times. I assure you that every measure is being taken to keep our expenses under tight control and to hold the rate of increase more in line with the rate of increase in sales. *Contributions* are expected to increase in the amount of \$20,085 or 5.5% in excess of last year. *Total office expenses* are budgeted at 4.1% over 1968 and *General Fund* expenses 5.2% lower. The lower General Fund expense is due primarily to the elimination of certain non-recurring items such as the membership survey and the Twenty-Eighth International Congress meeting. Total net income is estimated to be \$12,600. This estimate does not take into consideration a possible dividend from the Grapevine in 1969.

FINANCE (cont'd from p. 34)

Our Traditions, and particularly Tradition Seven, indicate that A.A. and its groups should be self-supporting and that contributions from outside sources should be declined. Consequently, it is the responsibility of all of us, every group and every member, to provide to the best of our ability the wherewithal which will enable G.S.O. to continue to carry on its worldwide services to an expanding fellowship. Anything less will most assuredly jeopardize our proud Tradition Seven. We at G.S.O. are constantly aware of this responsibility and try to act accordingly. I sincerely hope that you, ladies and gentlemen, will carry back and instill in your groups the same sense of responsibility, so that the help we receive from your group contributions will not only continue but increase. Only with that kind of help can we adequately meet the problems of ever increasing expenses.

—Robert W.P. Morse, *Chairman*,

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE

The major activities of your International Committee during the past year have been concerned with A.A. structure overseas, more effective translation and distribution of A.A. literature, and with public information.

The International Committee was established in the fall of 1963 to meet a need for wider sharing of A.A. experience in connection with the development and growth of A.A. groups outside the North American continent.

The committee reviews the progress, problems, and needs of overseas A.A. and makes recommendations as to the sharing of service experience with foreign countries.

There seems to be a direct relationship between the growth of A.A. in a country and the degree to which A.A. literature is available in the language of that country. Recommendations regarding literature translation needs have therefore been an important function of the committee.

We have worked to establish and maintain a policy for translation of literature and have set up guidelines for establishing committees. We have also contacted volunteers in this country who are available to check translations to see that they are as faithful as possible to the originals.

Once literature is translated it must be made available to A.A. members as quickly and economically as possible. In the beginning this is done through G.S.O. But as A.A. grows in an area it is better to have the literature handled through local literature distribution centers. This means organization. For this reason much of our time is spent advising groups on structure and encouraging them to assume the responsibility for their own service needs when they seem to be ready.

We also try to encourage groups overseas to make themselves known to the public through newspapers, radio, and television. At the same time we are trying to encourage the establishment of A.A. in countries where it is unknown. There are indications now, for instance, of some A.A. activity in Italy. Not much, but a beginning.

A good deal of our information regarding A.A. overseas comes to us through correspondence. However, some of our finest evaluation of what is going on in other countries comes to us through visits made by our traveling committee members. A number of them have been traveling in various parts of the world so far this year, and additional trips are planned during the summer and fall.

—Niles P., *Chairman*

LITERATURE COMMITTEE

The Trustees' Literature Committee, with the help and cooperation of the Conference Literature Committee, completed or continued work on a number of projects in the past year.

Among these was an entirely new version of "A.A. for the Woman." "It Happened to Alice," the comic-style pamphlet for women, has also been completed.

"Young People and A.A." with new stories has been completed and will be distributed shortly, while the pamphlet, "A.A. in the Armed Services," is in the works.

In addition, the illustrated "Traditions" pamphlet is being prepared. Work is also going forward to add up-to-date materials to "A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee" and "A.A. and the Medical Profession."

At the same time the committee is sending questionnaires to a selected number of groups and intergroups to determine literature needs, and work is going forward on the possibility of improving on the questions in "Is A.A. For You?" Other matters under consideration by the committee during the past year concerned preparation of material for oldtimers and material on danger signs that could lead to drinking.

—Austin MacCormick, *Chairman*
Trustees' Literature Committee

NOMINATING COMMITTEE

The Nominating Committee, which meets at least once each quarter, is made up of a number equal to that of the Conference Committee on Trustees, currently ten. Some of the committee's actions during the past year include:

(cont'd on p. 36)

NOMINATING (from p. 35)

1. Recommended that Robert P. be elected as an A.A. general service trustee.
2. Reaffirmed that no change be made in the present procedure for electing regional trustees, but referred the following proposal from the Nevada past delegate to the Conference Committee on Trustees: "That regional trustees be chosen by Third Legacy procedure with all the delegates voting. That these (90, presently) votes be the only votes cast."
3. Reviewed the recommendation from the 1968 Conference Trustees' Committee meeting that the possibility of electing one trustee candidate from each Conference area, rather than one from each state or province was referred to the 1969 Conference Trustees' Committee for further review:

That a trustee candidate *may* be elected from each Conference area, or that two or more of the Conference areas within a state or province may jointly propose a single candidate.

4. Recommended the following procedure for the election of general service trustees at large.

The Board would set up "specifications" to cover the kind of business and professional qualifications needed to fill a vacancy. All states and all provinces (depending on whether the trustee was scheduled to be from the U.S. or Canada) would be asked to submit qualified names by January 15. In other words, if the trustee was to come from the U.S., only those Conference areas in the United States would be asked to submit candidates. And vice versa.

The Conference Committee on Trustees would be invited to meet with the Trustees' Nominating Committee in joint session on the Sunday preceding the first Conference session to discuss all candidates and to reduce the number to four for each vacancy.

At the Conference, the delegates from either the U.S. or Canada, plus the Trustees' Nominating Committee, would vote. The Third Legacy procedure as employed in the election of regional trustees would be used.

5. The Committee reviewed the suggestion from a delegate that when a Region again has a chance to elect a trustee candidate, the state where the previous trustee was elected would be eliminated. It was the sense of the meeting that such a limitation would not be desirable.
6. Recommended that all Class B regional trustee candidates received from the Northeast and Western Canada Regions be presented for election of one nominee from each Region during the 19th Annual meeting of the General Service Conference.

7. Reviewed the 1968 Conference Committee's recommendation that the electoral procedure used in the election of regional trustees be employed in all Third Legacy elections. (Referred to the Conference Policy Committee at their April, 1969, meeting.)
8. Approved the resume of Stephen O., Sr., and recommend that he be presented to the General Service Board at their annual meeting.
9. Recommended that the following be accepted as nominees for trustees of the General Service Board and approved for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April, following their presentation to the General Service Conference for approval.

Non-A.A. Trustees

Dr. Travis Dancey
Dr. Vincent Dole
Austin MacCormick
Robert W.P. Morse
Hon. John Murtagh
Dr. John L. Norris
Archibald Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith

A.A. Trustees

Andy A.
Eric B.
Rollie D.
William C. (elect. April, 1969)
Don F.
Charles L., Jr. (through July, 1969)
Stephen O., Sr. (to be elected as Class B General Service trustee, to become effective at the end of July, 1969)
Robert P.
Bayard P., Jr.
Katharine P.
John R. (elected April, 1969)
Maurice R.
Ruth W.

10. That the following officers of the General Service Board be approved for election at the April quarterly meeting of the General Service Board, after being presented to the General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Chairman:
First Vice Chairman:
Second Vice Chairman:
Treasurer:
Secretary:
Assistant Secretary:

Dr. John L. Norris
Bernard B. Smith
Eric B.
Robert W.P. Morse
Ruth W.
Waneta N.

—Ed L., Jr., chairman

HARRISON TRICE RETIRES

Harrison M. Trice, Ph.D., nonalcoholic member of the Board of Trustees since April, 1957, announced at the Conference his plans to retire as a trustee. As a member of the Trustees' Policy Committee, Harry has spoken knowledgeably on many issues and has offered valuable suggestions as to how A.A. could better carry the message to alcoholics who still suffer. For his many contributions and for his long and valued friendship we are indeed grateful.

Relationship Between A.A. and Al-Anon

The Conference approved the recommendation to incorporate into the existing A.A. Guidelines the questions on how A.A. and Al-Anon can cooperate with regard to central offices and area and regional get-togethers and conventions.

QUESTION: "Should A.A. and Al-Anon have combined central (or intergroup) services and offices?"

ANSWER: Both experience and the Twelve Traditions of A.A. and Al-Anon suggest that each Fellowship will function more effectively if each retains separate committees, staff, and facilities for handling telephone and personal calls, as well as separate telephone answering services, intergroup activities, bulletins, meeting lists and all types of twelfth-step services. Also, that the members involved in each service committee or office be A.A. members, if an A.A. facility, and Al-Anon, if an Al-Anon facility.

QUESTION: "How may A.A. and Al-Anon cooperate in area and regional conventions and get-togethers?"

ANSWER: This answer depends on whether it is an A.A. convention or an Al-Anon convention. The former are growing in number.

In accordance with the Twelve Traditions, a convention would be either A.A. or Al-Anon — not both. However, most A.A. convention committees invite Al-Anon to participate by planning its own program, and the committee arranges for facilities for the Al-Anon meetings. If A.A. invites Al-Anon to participate in this manner, all expenses involved in the Al-Anon meetings are paid from the funds of the A.A. Convention Committee.

QUESTION: "Should an A.A. Convention committee make a contribution to Al-Anon from the financial profits of the convention?"

ANSWER: In accordance with the self-support Traditions of both Fellowships and to abide by the concept of "cooperation but not affiliation," it is suggested that A.A. should not make gifts or contributions to Al-Anon. By the same token, A.A. should not accept contributions from Al-Anon.

Bill's Statement On His Finances

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie:

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership.

Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilbur Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,

Bill

(Signed in full)

WGWNW

P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

The Conference also approved the following resolution of gratitude to the Fellowship of Al-Anon Family Groups:

Whereas, it is the desire of this Conference to confirm the relationship between Alcoholics Anonymous and Al-Anon Family Groups, and

Whereas, it is the further desire of this Conference to acknowledge A.A.'s debt of gratitude to the Al-Anon Family Groups, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED, that Alcoholics Anonymous recognizes the special relationship which it enjoys with the Al-Anon Family Groups, a separate but similar fellowship. And be it further resolved that Alcoholics Anonymous wishes to recognize, and hereby does recognize, the great contributions which the Al-Anon Family Groups have made, and are making, in assisting the families of alcoholics everywhere.

Bill and Speakers Reaffirm Spirit of A.A.

Bill, in bringing the 19th meeting of the General Service Conference to a close, spoke briefly but movingly of A.A.'s stature and strength, of its still bright future and safe harbor for fellow sufferers yet to come:

"It is my conviction that the men and women of A.A. will continue to help themselves and others over the coming years. This, despite the fact that we are living in the most perilous of times — perils imminent and perils potential.

"Furthermore, I do not think that the men and women of A.A. are afraid. I think that collectively we have seen about every brand of trouble there is. And we have, all of us, more than a nodding acquaintance with death.

"We have, through the Grace of God, been able to survive. And I think we reason that if we are entitled to salvation, why not the rest of the folks out there when they get around to it."

—Bill W.

"We Can Do More. . . ."

"There is still too little understanding of the problem of alcoholism and the problem of alcoholism in our society," Dr. Jack Norris said, in addressing the closing session of the Conference. "It is time, I think, for us to get people to understand that there is a great difference between the practicing alcoholic and the recovering alcoholic.

"Certainly A.A. as a movement can do little more than is already being done. But as individuals each of us has a responsibility. Many A.A. people are providing the heart of recovery in the agencies and institutions that are doing something about alcoholism. I think this will always be so. And a lot more can be done by each one of us in our community if we continue to hold out the hand of A.A. to those who reach for help."

—John L. Norris, M.D.
Chairman, General Service Board

"Rotation Is Necessary"

There have been times when I thought that rotation is the one mistake we may have made in this entire structure. Yet at the same time there comes upon me a tremendous certainty that now is the time that I should go. Rotation is the thing that has saved our Society. I know this, and it is a comfortable feeling.

I once thought that the only miracle of A.A. was the miracle of recovery. But there are a number of miracles; one is the miracle of A.A.'s very existence and structure, for it is conceived in the love of God and is motivated to survive as a whole. If we don't survive as a Fellowship, we won't survive as groups or as individual A.A.'s. Yet I feel that we need not have any fear as long as we remember that God is the one ultimate authority in our lives and in the life of our Fellowship. —Tom B., *retiring Trustee Western Canada*

". . . a Moving Experience"

A.A. is more than the sum total of its members. I feel that at this Conference we stand in the presence of a Power greater than all of us. It is a power of which the group conscience is but one of many manifestations.

The Conference is demanding and disconcerting. It has tested many of the firmest of my convictions. It is trying and fatiguing, at times frustrating, inspiring and uplifting. It has at times made me feel like the most dedicated A.A. in the world; at others I have wanted to resign.

What I am saying is that no one could possibly attend this Conference and not be moved. No one could share and participate and not be permeated by the highly spiritual flow of power that covers and pervades each and every session. Truly it is spirituality in action.

—Tom G.
Area Delegate Chairman

"A Loyal Opposition"

I decided that the best service I can possibly give to A.A. is to resign. I believe there are a whole series of occupations and professions that need to be represented on your board. And I urge you to reach out and get them to serve. I firmly believe in the principle of rotation for alcoholics and nonalcoholics alike.

As I leave I would like to suggest that A.A. always have a well-defined loyal opposition, the kind that questions and asks and makes liars out of those sociologists who conclude that any voluntary organization will inevitably become a collection of oligarchies. A.A. has defied this in the past, and I hope will continue to defy it.

Finally, I would like to express my deep appreciation. I have been an outsider and never pretended otherwise. At the same time I have been loved, and listened to. Thank you, then, for the opportunities, the joys, the experience, the opportunity to learn to share and to make a contribution.

—Harrison M. Trice, Ph.D.
Class A Trustee, retiring

"Grateful to Serve"

I'm sure I could never find words to express my gratitude for all the wonderful things that have happened in my life since I came into A.A. I have been one of your regional trustees for the past four years without ever forgetting to be an active member of my own A.A. group. These years as a member of your General Service Board have been exciting ones for me.

It started in Toronto in 1965 at our wonderful 30th Anniversary Convention where our Declaration of Responsibility was accepted by our membership. In 1966 we accepted more of our responsibility for A.A. affairs through the ratio change in the General Service Board. In October of this year we will have a World Service Meeting with our friends from overseas.

I don't know what my contribution has been to these and the many other events that have occurred. But I have felt responsible to the men and women in A.A. whom I have served.

—Frank R., retiring Trustee
Northeast Region

"Just Learning How to Help"

Some six years ago, I was asked to observe a Grapevine's Directors' meeting. I was subsequently asked to serve on the board. A few years later I was asked to serve as a trustee and I have had the honor since to serve as chairman of both the Grapevine Board and the Trustees' Nominating Committee.

Now it seems to me when it is time to leave that after four years on the General Service Board I am beginning to get just a slight glimmer of how I can be of some help to the experienced staff people. I have enjoyed six years of Conferences and it's been an immense pleasure to see this evidence of unity, solidarity, continuance and the spreading of the message in A.A. by delegates who come from all parts of the U.S. and Canada. —Ed LaL., retiring General Service Trustee

HOSPITALITY

It seems that there is an improvement each year in the magnificent job done by the Hospitality Committee in providing delegates' wives with entertainment, sightseeing tours and other activities. And this year the committee, made up of local A.A. members, did it again. There were visits to N.Y.C. Intergroup and Al-Anon headquarters, TV shows, museum tours, shopping trips, special fashion shows, lectures and lunches. At the same time the committee maintained a hospitality suite where from 40 to 80 people a day dropped in to chat with local A.A. members who were on duty to serve coffee and give advice and direction.

SURVEY (from p. 18)

Over and above its basic use, i.e. providing our friends in medicine, science, and government with some factual dimensions of A.A., this data bank can be used:

To develop additional information, such as the factors that distinguish the early successes from those who must come around for some time before getting sober; and

As a benchmark against which our future progress can be measured, and

As a guide to future directions.

—John H.

A.A. STORY FEATURED

I'd like to tell you a little bit about a feature story that appeared as a result of our press conference.

It was based on an interview with Bill which took place after the press conference. It appeared in the *National Observer* and was written by Joe Western (a nonalcoholic writer). The story itself was an excellent one. Full columns, two pages, and the headline was "Why Experts Say Alcoholics Anonymous Still Is the Drinkers Pal." The subheading was "All the Drunks Were Roaring with Laughter." This appeared throughout the nation.

After that, the *National Observer*, on its own hook, took full-page ads in leading publications, advertising this article. The copy said, "My name is Fred, and I am an Alcoholic." ("Fred" is a model, not a member of A.A.)

The ad itself appeared in the *New York Times*, *Detroit Free Press*, *Chicago Tribune* and in *Advertising Age* and *Advertising News of New York*, the latter two being trade publications. So there were several exposures.

—Tom R.

A.A.'s HAVE ADVANTAGE

Whether they are professional public relations people or not, most A.A.'s have a distinct advantage in working with the press. That competitive edge is honesty. Another advantage is that they are not seeking personal gain. They are doing it to help someone else. So, you approach your local editor or radio or television station with the knowledge that you are not really asking a personal favor. You are trying to provide him with information for a story which, hopefully, will interest him and his readers or listeners. And although ours is a program of attraction, we must still carry the message. News media offers a mass outlet in reaching the alcoholic who still suffers.

—Rex M.

Conference Committee Reports

The following reports were presented to the Conference by Committee Chairmen and their acceptance by the Delegates constituted Advisory Actions of the Conference.

AGENDA — ADMISSIONS

The Conference Committee on Agenda/Admissions:

1. Recommended that when an elected delegate cannot attend the annual meeting of the General Service Conference, the alternate delegate seated at the Conference will be considered delegate until notification is sent to G.S.O. by the area committee (as defined in the "Third Legacy Manual") that the originally elected delegate is ready to resume his duties.
2. Recommended that a two-year moratorium be declared on applications by the areas for additional delegate representation, so that a thorough study can be made of the whole subject.
3. Recommended that non-Conference members from all Trustees' Committees have permission to attend as observers, two at a time from each committee, the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.
4. Recommended that the committee continue to advise G.S.O. on agenda content and format and its broad approval of same follow the Board's approval in January.
5. Recommended that the Conference format rotate emphasis on Workshops and Presentations on a yearly basis, with a greater emphasis upon Workshops.
6. Suggested agenda subjects for the 1970 General Service Conference:
 - a. How can A.A. better cooperate with outside agencies, i.e. courts, medical profession, etc.?
 - b. The problem of the A.A. member and "pills."
 - c. How can the percentage of groups contributing be improved to meet financial responsibilities?

The following recommendations from the Sept. 7, 1968, meeting were discussed and tabled:

1. That a standard form be prepared for us in applications for additional delegates and that it include pertinent A.A. information.

2. That each state or province review its own delegate situation to see whether it may not already be over-represented.
3. The reaffirmation of the 1957 Conference action which states, "Requests for admission to come from state, provincial or territorial committees as a whole, rather than from an area," but recommended further discussion re the following change:

"That where there is more than one delegate in a state or province, that a two-thirds majority approval, rather than unanimous approval, be sufficient for future applications for additional representation."

At the same Sept. 7, 1968, meeting, the committee reviewed a request from California for an additional delegate and recommended that it be resubmitted with additional pertinent A.A. information and all five delegates' signatures. As of February, 1969, the California delegates withdrew their application for an additional delegate.

Elected Art K., So. California, as committee chairman for 1970.

FINANCE

The Conference Committee on Finance:

1. Approved the report of the General Service Board's Finance Committee.
2. Approved the 1969 G.S.O. and Grapevine budgets.
3. Unanimously approved of the proposal to change the basis for area support of the General Service Conference, and it was recommended that the Policy Committee give favorable consideration to this proposal.
4. Discussed the need for a new "money folder" to help increase contributions and recommended that the folder last issued in 1963, called "What Happens When You Put \$3.00 in the Hat," be rewritten and brought up to date.
5. It was felt that the G.S.O. filmstrip was very effective in letting members know about G.S.O. and encouraging them to contribute. The committee suggested that all delegates show the G.S.O. filmstrip as often as possible, just prior to their discussion of the need for contributions and support.
6. Elected Neal L., Arkansas, as committee chairman for 1970. Robert A., Iowa, was elected alternate chairman.

INSTITUTIONS

The Conference Committee on Institutions:

1. Recommended that guidelines be prepared, outlining procedures for A.A. members to follow in working with institutions and ways of informing the nonalcoholic staff about A.A. The following committee recommendations are to be included in the guidelines:

- a. That A.A.'s attending meetings at prisons or hospitals should be selected carefully, so that relations with the institutional staff remain harmonious.
- b. That A.A.'s position on membership in institutional groups be defined as follows:

"We cannot give A.A. membership to nonalcoholic narcotic addicts and other unrelated groups or organizations. A.A. groups in institutions can welcome anyone with problems other than alcohol to inside *open* meetings, but it is suggested that they do not speak or otherwise participate in these meetings."

2. Recommended that the *Institutions Bulletin* should have a wider distribution.
3. Recommended that A.A.'s should work towards coordination of all institutional work in the state or province, so that there will be cooperation between all local, intergroup and general service Institutional Committees.
4. Recommended that the Institutions Directories be distributed every two years with yearly supplements.
5. Elected Alex B., Washington, as committee chairman for 1970.

LITERATURE

The Conference Committee on Literature:

1. Recommended that the story of a young A.A. be added to the next reprint of the book "Alcoholics Anonymous," and that the present stories be edited, when necessary, in order that current readers will be able to identify.
2. Recommended that no additions to present Conference-approved literature be made at this time.
3. Recommended that material illustrating the General Service Office and the history of A.A. in cartoon style be considered.

4. Recommended that more effective ways of displaying Conference-approved literature be explored; that the delegates be polled for their suggestions and results be made available to A.A. groups.
5. Suggested that one group member be chosen to be solely responsible for the distribution of Conference-approved literature and its display.
6. Elected Al D., Washington, as committee chairman for 1970.

GRAPEVINE

The Conference Grapevine Committee:

1. Recommended that A.A. World Services, Inc. and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., with the primary purpose of the Fellowship foremost in mind, study their promotional efforts in each other's behalf and extend to each other the fullest cooperation in making the Fellowship aware of the tools of A.A.
2. Recommended that all delegates consider it a part of their responsibility to make the Fellowship aware of the Grapevine as a tool of sobriety, either through their own efforts or by recruiting others.
3. Elected Charles D., Cen. Michigan, as committee chairman for 1970.

CONFERENCE PUBLIC INFORMATION

The Conference Committee on Public Information:

1. Recommended that material be prepared and included in the P.I. Kits, which emphasizes the importance of local P.I.C.'s taking care that their announcements, public meetings, and releases to news media concern the A.A. program of recovery and not the professional field of alcoholism.
2. Recommended that no special material for judges, law-enforcement people, or teachers be considered at the present time.
3. Recommended that G.S.O. consider sending a questionnaire to delegates and P.I. Committees on the subject of cooperation between A.A. members and affiliates of the North American Association of Alcoholism Programs.
4. Recommended that the General Service Conference approve the following resolution of the Trustees'

(cont'd on p. 42)

ADVISORY ACTIONS

P.I. (from p. 41)

Policy Committee and the General Service Board of Trustees:

"We will endeavor to avoid participation on radio and TV programs, unless

a. We are given adequate time for preparation.

b. Our presence will serve an A.A. objective.

c. The primary discussion is appropriate for A.A.—not concerned with crime, sex, controversy or any other sensationalism.

d. We are satisfied our anonymity is guaranteed."

5. Elected Junior A., Eastern Massachusetts, as committee chairman for 1970.

CONFERENCE REPORT AND CHARTER

The Committee on the Conference Report and Charter:

1. Approved the final draft of the "A.A. Service Manual," a new revision of the "Third Legacy Manual," with the understanding that minor editorial changes can still be made which do not affect meaning or content.
2. Unanimously approved the suggested changes to the Conference Charter: (1) That Article 1, paragraph 1, line two, be amended by the addition of the words "...The Twelve Steps," the sentence now to read: "...the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is the guardian of the world services, and of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous." (2) That article 3, paragraph 2, line one, be amended to read: "But no change in Article 12 of the Charter or in the Twelve Traditions of A.A.," instead of "...the A.A. Tradition, etc." Also, it be understood that the new approved procedure for electing general service trustees at large be incorporated in the Charter.
3. Agreed that the contents of the 1969 *Conference Report* be simplified by grouping related information by categories to provide ready reference to subject material.
4. Recommended that the practice of listing first name and last initial of A.A. Conference members in the *Conference Box 4-5-9* and *Final Report* be sustained. Full names and addresses, however, may be used in the roster section only of the *Final Report*.
5. Elected Carl LeB., N.W. Ontario, as committee chairman for 1970.

TRUSTEES

The Conference Committee on Trustees:

1. Disapproved the suggestion that a state or province having a regional trustee be eliminated from submitting a candidate to their next regional trustee election.
2. Recommended that the following candidates be presented for election as trustees of the General Service Board:

Travis Dancey, M.D.
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Austin MacCormick
Robert W.P. Morse
Hon. John Murtagh
John L. Norris, M.D.
Archibald Roosevelt
Bernard B. Smith

Arthur A.
Eric B.
William C.
Rollie D.
Donald F.
Charles L. Jr.
(through July, 1969)
Robert P.
Bayard P. Jr.
Katharine P.
John R.
Maurice R.
Ruth W.

3. Recommended the name of Stephen O., Sr., as an A.A. general service trustee for election at the annual meeting of the General Service Board, to become effective at the end of July, 1969.
4. Recommended that the following be elected as officers of the General Service Board at its annual meeting, following the Conference in April:

Chairman:
First Vice Chairman:
Second Vice Chairman:
Treasurer:
Secretary:
Assistant Secretary:

John L. Norris, M.D.
Bernard B. Smith
Eric B.
Robert W.P. Morse
Ruth W.
Waneta N.

5. Disapproved the proposal for a suggested change in electoral procedures for regional trustees which would increase the voting body to all delegates and eliminate the trustees from voting. The reasons for this are: it would increase or encourage politicking on the floor of the Conference and thus divert the delegates from their primary purpose; in all probability it would increase the length of time required by the Conference and, therefore, incur great unnecessary expense. Trustees should have some voice in voting for the person with whom they will be working.
6. Disapproved a proposal to enable each Conference area, if it so desires, to select its own regional trustee candidate and recommended that it be held over for further study.
7. Recommended that the procedure for the election of a general service trustee at large be accepted.

(to p. 43)

TRUSTEES (from p. 42)

8. Recommended that resumes of all regional trustee candidates be prepared by a person other than the candidate himself. That his qualifications be itemized rather than in paragraph form, limited to one page, using the G.S.O. Resume Sheet.
9. Elected Joe H., No. Indiana, as committee chairman for 1970.

CONFERENCE POLICY

The Committee on Conference Policy:

1. Recommended that the name of the Conference Policy Committee be changed to "Committee on Conference Policy."
2. Agreed that biographical sketches of the delegates, compiled by G.S.O. and placed in delegates' manuals, would serve no useful purpose to the delegates or to G.S.O.
3. Recommended that the "Electoral procedure for the election of Class B regional trustee nominee" be used in all Third Legacy elections and further, that this suggestion be incorporated in the "Third Legacy Manual," now under revision.
4. Looked with favor on the proposal "that each Conference area contribute \$150 every year to the support of the General Service Conference" and suggested the delegates take it back to their areas for consideration. It was further suggested that this item be placed on the 1970 General Service Conference agenda.
5. Elected Marie L., Cen. & S.E. Ohio, as committee chairman for 1970.

'DELEGATES ONLY' MEETING

The Area Delegates Only meeting opened at 8:07 p.m., Wednesday, April 23, with the recitation in unison of the Serenity Prayer. The following business was conducted by the meeting.

1. Delegates elected to the World Service Meeting in October, 1969:

Panel 18—Warren S., So. Coastal, Calif.
Alternate: Hal V., No. Dakota

Panel 19—Charles D., Cen. Michigan
Alternate: Bill W., Chicago, Illinois

2. Suggested that the Sunday afternoon delegates' reception be continued as a hospitality fellowship reception of an informal nature, rather than as a more formal planned or pre-arranged meeting.
3. It was the expression of the meeting that inasmuch as G.S.O. is now giving consideration to relocation of the office in New York, consideration might also be given to the relocation of the site of this annual meeting, with a view to returning to single-room accommodations, so that the advantages of private meditation, study, thought and rest might be restored. It was further suggested that the rising costs of the annual meeting might be controlled, or at least reduced, by a study of possible alternative hotel accommodations.
4. Bob B., Oklahoma, was elected as the new Delegate Chairman for the 20th Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

—Tom G.
Area Delegates Chairman

The conference also confirmed the procedure for the election of a Class B regional trustee nominee.

THREE NEW TRUSTEES

Following three-minute presentations and voting under Third Legacy procedures, the following names were presented to the General Service Board for election as Class B (alcoholic) trustees. Their biographies can be found on pp. 50-51.

BILL C.: Elected as regional trustee from the Northeast Region.

JOHN R.: Elected as regional trustee from the Western Canada Region.

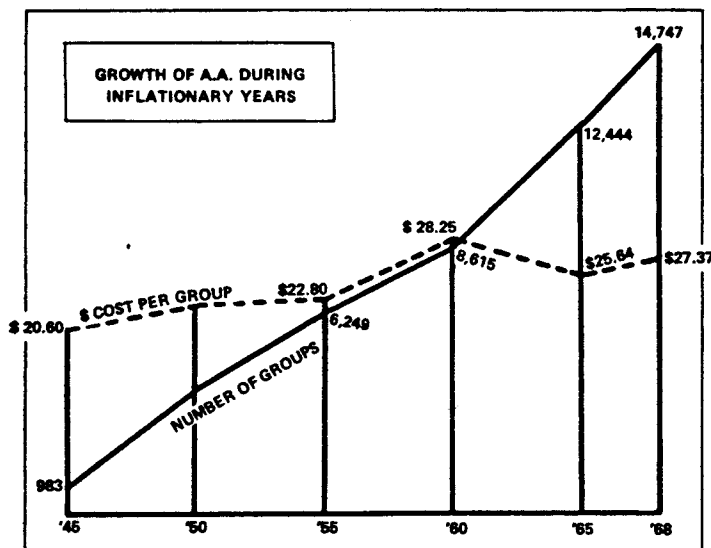
STEPHEN O., Sr.: Elected as general service trustee, to start serving the end of July 1969.

Growth & Money at G.S.O.

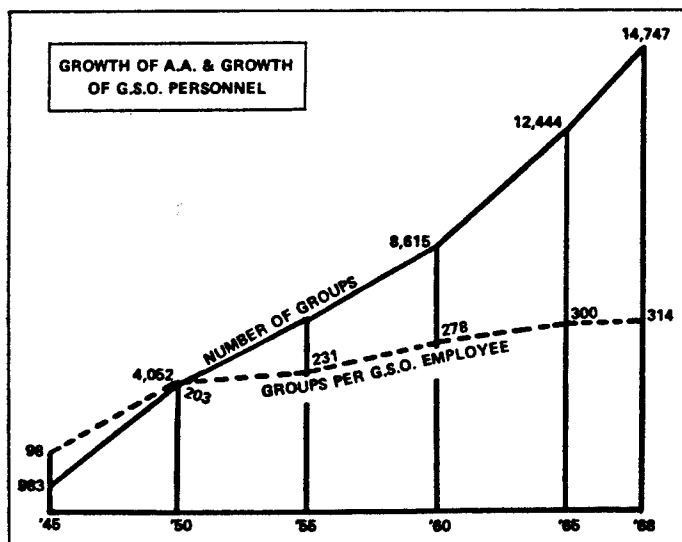
How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel — in 1945 there was one employee for each 98 groups. Today, one employee serves each 314 groups.

During the past twenty three years, the G.S.O. budget has increased from \$20,000 to \$420,300 for services charged to the group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 97%. Adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services per group actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$14.46.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Cost
1945	983	10	98	\$20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1968	14,747	47	314	27.37	197



1. (Above) There are more than 15 times as many groups today as in 1945. The number of services has increased greatly, too, in the same period. Today, however, there are 314 groups for each G.S.O. employee, compared with only 98 in 1945.



2. (Above) During the years 1945 through 1968, the cost of living increased 97 percent. Constant striving for increased efficiency succeeded in keeping G.S.O. service cost per group to \$27.37 in 1968 compared with \$20.60 in 1945, an increase of only 33 percent.

1969 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1969 Operations of G.S.O. activities — Exclusive of the A.A. Grapevine — is as follows:

BUDGET

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.—PUBLISHING

INCOME

Sales	\$445,600*
Less: Cost of Products	173,800
Gross Profit from Sales	271,800

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	\$ 87,200
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*Based upon the sale of:

- 44,000 Books—"Alcoholics Anonymous"
- 15,500 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Reg.)
- 5,600 Books—"12 Steps & 12 Traditions" (Pocket)
- 5,100 Books—"A.A. Comes of Age"
- 13,000 Books—"The A.A. Way of Life"
- Pamphlets & Miscellaneous Items

OFFICE EXPENSES — GROUP SERVICES

INCOME

Contributions	\$386,300
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TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	\$ (34,000)
----------------------------	-------------

**Includes cost of General Service Conference—\$37,700.

GENERAL FUND—TRUSTEES' EXPENSES

INCOME

\$ —0—

TOTAL EXPENSES

Excess of Income (Expense)	40,600***
	\$ (40,600)

***Board Meetings, P.I.C. Expense, Special Projects, Etc.

The Publishing activity will contribute \$74,600 to the budgeted deficits.

1969 Grapevine Budget

Estimated income from subscription and other sales.....	\$221,000
Estimated expenses	207,300
Net income from operations	13,700
Interest from savings accounts	6,000
Net income	\$ 19,700

1968 Group Contributions

U.S.	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alabama	68	47	69.2%	12	25.5%	\$ 2,949.44	1,187	\$ 2.48
Alaska	34	19	55.9	6	31.6	1,008.50	334	3.02
Arizona	118	68	57.6	15	22.1	3,441.24	1,435	2.40
Arkansas	74	51	68.9	17	33.3	2,259.05	898	2.52
California	1,258	757	60.2	234	30.9	45,224.08	27,767	1.63
Colorado	108	65	60.2	18	27.8	3,960.62	1,690	2.17
Connecticut	177	109	61.6	21	19.3	7,427.95	2,983	2.49
Delaware	32	27	84.4	7	25.9	1,092.00	495	2.21
Dist. of Columbia	46	40	86.6	18	45.0	3,436.71	999	3.44
Florida	282	185	65.6	63	34.1	16,262.47	4,873	3.34
Georgia	146	100	68.5	23	23.0	4,486.88	2,033	2.21
Hawaii	35	22	62.9	4	18.2	742.25	524	1.42
Idaho	36	23	63.9	3	13.1	785.90	372	2.11
Illinois	550	486	88.3	36	7.4	11,090.37	11,755	.94
Indiana	198	123	62.1	22	17.9	7,116.94	2,560	2.78
Iowa	107	67	62.6	12	17.9	5,668.60	2,109	2.69
Kansas	107	63	58.9	8	12.7	3,310.05	1,923	1.72
Kentucky	108	74	68.5	4	5.4	5,599.29	1,380	3.06
Louisiana	94	52	55.3	13	25.0	3,192.99	1,644	1.94
Maine	57	42	73.7	6	14.3	1,590.50	632	2.52
Maryland	142	92	64.8	15	16.3	4,804.80	2,006	2.40
Massachusetts	281	147	52.3	28	19.1	8,373.09	5,418	1.55
Michigan	381	214	56.2	46	21.5	17,646.53	6,406	2.76
Minnesota	246	219	89.0	12	5.5	9,182.04	5,403	1.70
Mississippi	48	25	52.1	5	20.0	1,237.50	654	1.89
Missouri	160	101	63.1	15	15.0	5,714.60	2,143	2.67
Montana	55	40	72.8	5	8.0	1,208.09	573	2.11
Nebraska	75	53	70.7	8	15.1	2,388.45	786	3.04
Nevada	51	27	52.9	7	25.9	1,519.75	756	2.01
New Hampshire	36	22	61.1	8	36.4	1,435.10	503	2.85
New Jersey	267	182	68.2	46	25.3	11,542.30	4,332	2.67
New Mexico	63	31	49.2	3	10.0	1,890.78	1,091	1.73
New York	583	379	65.0	120	31.7	30,484.60	10,120	3.01
North Carolina	159	123	77.4	29	23.6	7,830.53	2,527	3.10
North Dakota	46	28	60.9	3	10.7	934.90	454	2.06
Ohio	456	265	58.1	39	14.7	13,479.75	8,946	1.51
Oklahoma	109	85	78.0	46	54.1	5,479.48	1,613	3.40
Oregon	106	87	82.1	21	24.2	3,576.40	1,113	3.21
Pennsylvania	297	209	70.4	52	24.9	13,083.20	4,464	2.93
Rhode Island	30	24	80.0	10	41.8	1,700.85	379	4.49
South Carolina	80	53	66.3	10	18.9	3,038.40	1,279	2.38
South Dakota	48	26	54.2	4	15.4	1,199.00	841	1.43
Tennessee	84	54	64.3	8	14.8	2,500.00	1,422	1.76
Texas	399	235	58.9	63	26.8	15,613.51	7,713	2.03
Utah	51	33	64.7	11	33.4	1,094.63	725	1.51
Vermont	31	24	77.4	3	12.5	1,756.45	411	4.27
Virginia	145	97	66.9	28	28.9	6,670.05	2,318	2.88
Washington	193	118	61.1	34	28.8	6,425.56	2,388	2.69
West Virginia	51	33	64.7	7	21.2	1,684.50	575	2.93
Wisconsin	213	136	63.9	16	11.7	6,144.11	2,546	2.41
Wyoming	27	20	74.1	1	5.0	827.00	265	3.12
Commonwealth of P.R.	44	18	40.9	4	21.2	819.00	612	1.34
Canal Zone	2	1	50.0	1	100.0	275.00	28	9.82
Bahama Islands	1	1	100.0	0	0.0	10.00	21	.48
Virgin Islands of U.S.	2	2	100.0	0	0.0	65.00	12	5.42
Total for U.S.	8,595	5,624	65.4%	1,250	22.2%	\$322,280.78	148,424	\$ 2.17

CANADA	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
Alberta	145	77	53.1%	9	11.7%	\$ 4,134.02	1,344	\$ 3.08
Atlantic Prov.								
New Brunswick	53	22	41.5	3	13.6	677.33	581	1.17
Newfoundland	19	9	47.4	1	11.1	398.74	146	2.73
Nova Scotia	60	35	58.3	7	20.0	1,293.08	676	1.91
Prince Ed. Is.	23	12	52.2	1	8.3	587.00	319	1.84
British Columbia	205	103	50.2	12	11.7	4,947.56	2,476	1.88
Manitoba	76	38	50.0	3	7.9	2,688.13	1,514	1.78
N.W. Territories	2	1	50.0	0	0.0	25.00	10	2.50
Ontario	448	266	59.4	49	18.4	17,162.08	6,250	2.75
Quebec	375	174	46.4	29	16.7	4,574.41	6,644	.69
Saskatchewan	149	79	53.0	3	3.8	3,357.42	1,649	2.04
Yukon Terr.	1	1	100.0	0	0.0	55.10	20	2.76
TOTAL for CANADA	1,556	816	52.4%	117	14.3%	\$ 39,899.87	21,629	\$ 1.84
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	10,151	6,440	63.5%	1,367	21.2%	\$362,180.65	170,053	\$ 2.13
FOREIGN								
Foreign						\$ 2,351.87		
World Hello						95.70		
International Doctors						125.00		
Hospital Gps.						1,380.73		
Prison Gps.						239.50		
Internationalists						686.79		
GRAND TOTAL						\$367,060.24		

GROUP CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON -- 1968 - 1967

	# Gps. re- ported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	# Gps. R.C.P.	% of Gps. on R.C.P.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. per Capita
U.S.A. 1968	8,595	5,624	65.4%	1,250	22.2%	\$322,280.78	148,424	\$ 2.17
U.S.A. 1967	8,484	5,386	63.5	1,234	22.9	303,822.06	142,566	2.13
Increase (Decrease)	111	238	1.9%	16	(.7)%	\$ 18,458.73	5,858	\$.04
Canada 1968	1,556	816	52.4%	117	14.3%	\$ 39,899.87	21,629	\$ 1.84
Canada 1967	1,411	782	55.5	171	21.9	36,984.70	19,695	1.88
Increase (Decrease)	145	34	(3.1)%	(54)	(7.6)%	\$ 2,915.17	1,934	\$ (.04)
U.S. & Canada 1968	10,151	6,440	63.5%	1,367	21.2%	\$362,180.65	170,053	\$ 2.13
U.S. & Canada 1967	9,895	6,168	62.3	1,405	22.8	340,806.76	162,261	2.10
Increase (Decrease)	256	272	1.2%	(38)	(1.6)%	\$ 21,373.89	7,792	\$.03

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1968

	<u>1968</u>	<u>1967</u> (Note C)
INCOME		
Net Sales, after Book Discounts waived of \$32,825 in 1968 and \$32,148 in 1967	\$431,844	\$413,661
Less: Cost of Printing	120,656	118,240
Royalties	<u>47,606</u>	<u>46,990</u>
Gross Profit from Literature	263,582	248,431
Contributions — A.A. Groups and Members	366,215	346,431
Interest	<u>143</u>	<u>373</u>
Total Income	<u>\$629,940</u>	<u>\$595,235</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	\$326,294	\$297,846
Rent	35,097	34,725
Exchange Bulletin	14,001	13,053
World Directory	20,061	18,874
Other Service Office Printing	11,164	9,158
Shipping and Mailing	46,543	39,915
Other Office Expenses	48,492	46,655
Insurance and Taxes	26,478	24,358
Professional Services, Gifts	10,600	6,400
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	11,855	9,838
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	7,341	8,647
P.I.C., Travel	16,687	4,767
General Service Conference	36,571	32,388
Foreign Literature Aid	3,623	2,206
Film, Film Strip, Display Boards	4,034	4,723
Provision for EDP installation	<u>—</u>	<u>20,000</u>
Total Expense	<u>\$618,841</u>	<u>\$573,553</u>
NET INCOME FOR YEAR (Exhibit C)	<u>11,099</u>	<u>21,682</u>

NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION

World Service Office — Group Fund	\$(37,528)	\$(26,294)
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc.	91,321	74,796
General Fund — General Service Board	(42,694)	(26,820)

CHANGES IN OTHER FUNDS — 1968

	<u>Convention</u>	<u>Pension</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Balance, January 1, 1968	\$13,416	\$ 20,355	\$300,023
Book Discounts		32,825	
Contribution by A.A. Grapevine, Inc.		3,500	
Investment Income	615	1,232	14,376
Transfers (to) from Other Funds			(14,300)
Less: Current Funding Costs		(30,214)	
Actuary Fee		<u>(1,786)</u>	
Balance, December 31, 1968	<u>\$14,031</u>	<u>\$ 25,912</u>	<u>\$300,099</u>

() Denotes Red Figures

In these financial statements amounts under the heading "Service Office" combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of The General Service Board are further subdivided into Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The DEFERRED PENSION FUND, which was established in 1965 to receive moneys for the Retirement Plan for the benefit of employees of A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. prior to transfer to the Trustee of the A.A. Retirement Trust.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, for the costs of the General Service Conference.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1968

	1968	1967 (Note D)
INCOME – SUBSCRIPTIONS AND SALES	\$208,801	\$198,855
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS		
Salaries	32,709	36,934
Printing	45,635	42,989
Mailing	24,293	21,060
Other Printing Costs	2,040	1,616
Calendar Costs	5,926	4,673
Rent	5,224	5,286
Telephone	1,075	1,139
Office Supplies and Expense	1,404	3,598
Other Editorial Expense	3,475	—
Office Cleaning	500	500
Total	\$122,281	\$117,795
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS EXPENSE		
Salaries	\$ 36,770	\$ 33,839
Stationery and Supplies	2,576	1,915
Rent	5,224	5,285
Telephone	827	870
Office Expense	2,829	2,644
Selling	5,625	5,122
Postage	3,980	3,756
Office Cleaning	500	500
Bad Debts	293	271
Conference and Convention	334	—
Total	\$ 58,958	\$ 54,202
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	\$ 2,803	\$ 3,239
Legal and Accounting	3,100	2,400
Taxes	4,804	4,489
Meetings	385	484
New Equipment	695	463
Contribution to Retirement Fund	3,500	3,500
Total	\$ 15,287	\$ 14,575
TOTAL COST AND EXPENSE	\$196,526	\$186,572
INCOME FROM OPERATIONS	\$ 12,275	\$ 12,283
Add: Interest Received on Savings Accounts	5,064	4,168
NET INCOME FOR PERIOD (Exhibit C)	\$ 17,339	\$ 16,451

(continued from 46)

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

The CONVENTION GUARANTY FUND was established in 1967 by subscriptions from A.A. members in Miami, Florida, and by a transfer from the GENERAL FUND for the purpose of making up a deficit, if any, incurred in connection with the Convention to be held in Miami in 1970. To the extent not so used it is to be refunded to the original subscribers.

In the attached statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc., are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, and of the other Funds by their names.

NOTE A – After transfers of \$65,000 in 1968, and \$50,000 in 1967 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B – Advances of \$37,500 in 1968 and \$26,300 in 1967 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in group contributions in those years.

NOTE C – In 1968 the dividend paid the General Fund by The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. has been treated as a credit to net worth rather than as an item of income. In addition, salary of one employee, previously charged to writing, research, Bed-

(continued on page 48)

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1968

OPERATING FUNDS	December 31, 1968		December 31, 1967	
	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine	Service Office	A. A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$154,140	\$ 30,926	\$155,999	\$ 32,258
Saving Accounts and Certificates		115,074	12,200	95,009
Accounts Receivable	10,642	3,997	11,792	2,554
Due from Grapevine and Reserve Fund	22,300		25,500	
Inventories	112,500	2,439	85,400	1,217
Prepaid Expenses	5,028	3,426	6,197	8,685
Total Assets	<u>\$304,610</u>	<u>\$155,862</u>	<u>\$297,088</u>	<u>\$139,723</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	14,168	4,668	20,066	5,746
Due Pension Fund	2,382		22,361	
Due General Fund		8,000		7,000
Prepaid Subscriptions, Unearned Income		83,688		76,810
Reserve for Retirement Plan Payments		7,000		7,000
Reserve for EDP Installation	20,000		20,000	
Total Liabilities	<u>\$ 36,550</u>	<u>\$103,356</u>	<u>\$ 62,427</u>	<u>\$ 96,556</u>
NET WORTH				
Balance, January 1	234,661	43,167	201,779	33,716
Net Income for Year (Exhibits A and B)	11,099	17,339	21,682	16,451
Dividend (paid) or received	8,000	(8,000)	7,000	(7,000)
Transfers (to) from:				
Reserve Fund	14,300		30,700	
Convention Guaranty Fund			(6,500)	
Deferred Pension Fund			(20,000)	
Total Net Worth	<u>\$268,060</u>	<u>\$ 52,506</u>	<u>\$234,661</u>	<u>\$ 43,167</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
World Service Office - Group Fund (Note B)	\$ 11,156		\$ 11,184	
Publishing - A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	178,599		152,278	
General Fund - G.S.B. (Notes A and B)	78,305		71,199	
Total Operating Funds - as above	<u>\$268,060</u>		<u>\$234,661</u>	
Reserve Fund	300,099		300,023	
Deferred Pension Fund	25,912		20,355	
Convention Guaranty Fund	14,031		13,416	
Total Net Worth	<u>\$608,102</u>		<u>\$568,455</u>	
RESERVE, DEFERRED PENSION AND CONVENTION GUARANTY FUNDS				
	Reserve	Pension	Convention	
Cash	\$ 500			
Saving Accounts and Certificates	6,138	\$32,531	\$ 14,031	
Due from A.A.W.S. and General Fund		2,382		
U.S. Treasury Obligations	254,886			
Government Agency and Corporate Bonds	49,320			
Accrued Interest	3,555			
Less: Due General Fund	(14,300)			
A.A. Retirement Trust		(9,001)		
BALANCE, DECEMBER 31	<u>\$300,099</u>	<u>\$25,912</u>	<u>\$ 14,031</u>	

() Denotes Red Figures

(continued from 47)

ford Hills expense, has been included in salaries. The 1967 accounts in the attached statements have been restated to reflect these changes.

NOTE D - The 1968 costs of calendars and certain other items sold have been stated separately under editorial and printing costs, rather than as a deduction from sales, and the 1967 accounts have been restated to reflect these changes.

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared by the independent certified public accountants from the figures contained in their reports on the three separate corporations.

1969 CONFERENCE MEMBERS*

Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs

Bill Wilson — Co-founder

G.S.B. TRUSTEES

NONALCOHOLIC

John L. Norris, M.D. (Chairman)
Box 251
New London, N.H. 03257

Travis E. Dancey, M.D.
4015 Wilson Avenue
Montreal 28, Quebec, Canada

Vincent Dole, M.D.
Rockefeller Inst.
67th St. & York Ave.
New York, New York 10021

Leonard V. Harrison (Emeritus)
Box 383
Old Lyme, Connecticut 06371

Austin H. McCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30th Street
New York, New York 10016

Robert W.P. Morse (Treasurer)
Cove Road
Oyster Bay, L.I., N.Y. 11771

Hon. John Murtagh
Justice of the Supreme Court of
the State of N.Y.
100 Center Street
New York, New York 10013

Archibald B. Roosevelt
Roosevelt & Cross
40 Wall Street
New York, New York 10005

Bernard B. Smith (1st Vice Chairman)
460 Park Avenue
New York, New York 10022

Harrison M. Trice, Ph.D. (Ret. Apr. 1969)
School of Industrial &
Labor Relations
Cornell University
Ithaca, New York 14850

ALCOHOLIC

Arthur "Andy" Anderson
3565 Sunset Lane
Port Huron, Michigan 48060

Eric H. Bergman
8435 47 Avenue South
Seattle, Washington 98118

**Tom Breen
Box 453
Lac du Bonnet, Manitoba, Canada

Rollie G. Davidson
Habitat 67, Apt. 1022
Cite du Havre
Montreal 2, Que. Canada

Don Farrell
108 So. 53rd Street
Omaha, Nebraska 68132

**Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
(2nd Vice Chairman)
405 Lexington Avenue
New York, New York 10017

Robert G. Pearson
1 Jones Park
Riverside, Conn. 06878

Bayard Pope, Jr.
B. B. D. & O.
383 Madison Avenue
New York, New York

Katharine Prince
2305 Chidester Road
Camden, Arkansas 71701

Maurice E. Reilly, Jr.
7726 Jeannette Street
New Orleans, Louisiana 70118

**Frank Russell
159 Wentworth Avenue
Lowell, Massachusetts 01850

Ruth M. Weir (Secretary)
145 East 15 Street
New York, New York 10003

A.A. GRAPEVINE DIRECTORS

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr. (Chairman & President)
Jack Morley, (Editor)
Paula Carpenter (Vice President, Secretary)
Ruth Weir (Treasurer)
David A. Barron
Barry Leach
Austin MacCormick
Milton Maxwell, Ph.D.
Robert G. Pearson

A.A. WORLD SERVICES DIRECTORS

Robert E. Hitchins (Chairman)
Bayard Pope, Jr. (1st Vice Chairman)
Waneta New (2nd Vice Chairman)
Stephen Owen, Sr. (Treasurer)
Charles Milton
Robert Pearson
Niles Peebles
Hazel Rice (Secretary)

GRAPEVINE STAFF

Paula Carpenter
Jack Morley

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE STAFF

Robert E. Hitchins
Cora Louise Belford
Beth Kuhlmann
Ann Macfarlane
Midge McFadden
Waneta New
Hazel Rice
Mary Ellen Uribe

***Term ending (see p. 43 for A.A. trustees elected G.S.B. meeting, April 26, 1969)*

Al Cryan, Manager, Shipping
Rose Failla, Manager, Records
Kleina Jones, Manager, Special Services
Nell Wing, Production Editor, Box 4-5-9

Dennis Manders, Controller
Charles Columbia, Supervisor, Accounting
Wilbur A. Smith (Ind. C.P.A.)

Two Observers from: Public Information Committee
Two Observers from: International Committee
Two Observers from: Grapevine Editorial Board

**Members of Conference other than area delegates*

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Nonalcoholic Trustees

JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D. ... is chairman of the General Service Board and the General Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January 1951. "Dr. Jack" retired this year as associate medical director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, N.Y. He is chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism and a former president of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record suggests, Dr. Jack has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

TRAVIS E. DANCEY, M.D. ... elected to the Board in January 1965. He is chief of Service/Psychiatry at Queen Mary Veterans Hospital and senior psychiatrist of Montreal General Hospital. A good friend of the Fellowship since the formation of the first A.A. group in Quebec, Dr. Dancey is the first nonalcoholic trustee to serve from Canada. He serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

VINCENT P. DOLE, M.D. ... elected to the General Service Board in April 1965. He is a professor and physician at the Rockefeller Institute Hospital. Dr. Dole developed a method used in the treatment of narcotic addiction and is active in organizations dealing with this health problem. He serves on the International Committee of the General Service Board.

AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK ... elected to the General Service Board in April 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October 1949 to April 1951. He left in 1951 to become professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as executive director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a director of the A.A. Grapevine, a member of its corporate and editorial boards, and also serves on the Trustees' Nominating Committee and is chairman of its Literature Committee.

ROBERT W.P. MORSE ... elected to the General Service Board in July 1965. He is treasurer of the Board and currently chairman of its Finance & Budgetary Committee. Mr. Morse is executive vice president and treasurer of the Dime Savings Bank of Brooklyn. Born in Nova Scotia, Canada, he became a U.S.

citizen in 1931. During World War II he served as a finance officer in the U.S. Army in the Chinese Theatre Area. He is a director of the Mutual Savings Fund and married and the father of three children.

THE HON. JOHN M. MURTAGH ... elected to the Board in April 1963. He is a justice of the Supreme Court of the State of New York. Previously he had been administrative judge of the Criminal Court of New York, chief justice of the Court of Special Sessions, chief city magistrate, and commissioner of investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. Long a good friend of A.A., the judge brings to the Board a sure understanding of the alcoholism illness.

ARCHIBALD B. ROOSEVELT (former treasurer of the General Service Board and former chairman of the Trustees' Finance Committee) ... was elected to the Board in January 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt and Cross, Inc., and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs. He remains a member of the Finance Committee.

BERNARD B. SMITH ... is 1st vice chairman of the Board — was elected to the Board in June 1944 and has been very active, serving as chairman of the Board and General Service Conference from January 1951 to April 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire, from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth II, on her visit to the United States.

LEONARD V. HARRISON (Emeritus) ... first came on the Board in 1941. With the exception of his resignation from October 1950 to January 1953, he has been continually active in A.A. affairs. He served as chairman of the General Service Board from April 1956 to April 1961. For many years he served as director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Connecticut.

A.A. Trustees

ARTHUR "ANDY" ANDERSON ... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the East Central Region. He had his last drink in 1949. Andy was a delegate to the General Service Conference and helped to initiate a state-wide General Service Committee and P.I. Committee. He was instrumental in forming the Michigan State Police and is with Chrysler Corporation, in charge of government parts' inspection. Andy serves on the Trustees' Nominating and Policy Committees.

ERIC H. BERGMAN ... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the Pacific Region. He had his last drink in 1951. He has served as G.S.R., vice chairman and chairman of the Seattle Intergroup and delegate to the General Service Conference. He is purchasing manager for Sicks' Rainier Brewing Company. Eric serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

BILL COOGAN — Elected to the Board April, 1969, as trustee from the Northeast Region. Since his last drink 11½ years ago, Bill has served in many capacities from group treasurer to area delegate (1965-1966). He is a lawyer practicing in the metropolitan area of Boston, Massachusetts, where he lives. He is a member of the Harvard Alumni Association, the Boston College Alumni Association, the American Bar Association and the Massachusetts Trial Lawyers Association.

ROLLIE G. DAVIDSON ... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from Eastern Canada. He had his last drink in 1950. He has served as general secretary of the Intergroup at Montreal; chairman, Quebec General Service Committee; worked with the French translation of A.A. literature, and been a delegate to the General Service Conference. He is vice president and insurance engineer of Hagar and Pettigrew. Rollie serves on the Policy, Literature and Nominating Committees.

A.A. TRUSTEES (from page 50)

DONALD F. FARRELL... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1968 as trustee from the West Central Region. He had his last drink in 1943. Besides helping to start A.A. in Des Moines, he was one of the original members in Omaha. A former delegate, he is active in institutions work and court programs for alcoholics. Don owns and operates a photographic business. He is a member of the Trustees' Policy Committee.

STEPHEN OWEN, SR. - Elected to the Board April, 1969, to start serving the end of July. Steve had his last drink November, 1960. He has served as secretary, treasurer, program chairman, and G.S.R. for his group in Long Beach, Long Island; has had intergroup experience, serving as treasurer in 1962 and 1963. He has just retired as president of the Beacon Manufacturing Company, a textile firm.

ROBERT PEARSON... was elected to the General Service Board in July 1968. He had his last drink in 1961. He is a director of the Grapevine Corporate Board, as well as of A.A.W.S., Inc. He was chairman of the Public Information Committee of the New York Intergroup and is a former president of the Fairfield County (Conn.) Council on Alcoholism. He is an executive with Shell Oil Company.

BAYARD POPE, JR.... was elected to the General Service Board as a service trustee in January 1968. He had his last drink in 1959. He is presently chairman of the Public Information Committee. He was a member of the Steering Committee and chairman of the Public Information Committee of the Intergroup Association of New York and now is on the Executive Committee of the Community Council on Alcoholism. He is vice president and a director of Batten, Barton, Durstine and Osborn. Bayard also serves on the Trustees' Policy and Literature Committees and is a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.

KATHARINE PRINCE... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the Southwest Region. She had her last drink in 1949 and is a member of the Camden, Arkansas Group. She has been a G.S.R. in Oklahoma and Arkansas, an area committee member, and helped form the Tulsa (Oklahoma) Group. She was assistant secretary-treasurer of the Southwestern Art Association. Katharine serves on the Trustees' Literature and Policy Committees.

JOHN RAE - Elected to the Board April, 1969, as trustee from the Western Canada Region. John has been sober over 13 years, and has been active in group and area affairs, serving as delegate to the General Service Conference (1960-61). He is manager of the Medical Clinic, Swift Current, Saskatchewan, Canada and active in many civic associations in his region.

MAURICE E. REILLY, JR.... was elected to the General Service Board in April 1967 as trustee from the Southwest Region. He had his last drink in 1956. He has served as G.S.R., committee member, state chairman and delegate for Louisiana. He also served as vice chairman of the Central Office Board. He is an architect in private practice and is a member of several professional organizations. Maurice serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees.

RUTH M. WEIR... was elected to the General Service Board as a service trustee in April 1967. She had her last drink in 1954. She has been active with the New York Intergroup Association and is a director and treasurer of the Grapevine Board. She is a financial administrator for the J. Walter Thompson Company. Ruth also serves on the Trustees' Finance and Policy Committees and is secretary of the General Service Board.

Trustees' Meetings

The Board of Trustees will meet during the coming year on the following dates: July 28, October 27, 1969; January 26 and April 25, 1970.

TRUSTEES' COMMITTEES

APRIL 1969

FINANCE & BUDGETARY

Robert W.P. Morse, Chairman
Eric Bergman
Robert E. Hitchins
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Stephen Owens, Sr.
Maurice Reilly, Jr.
Archibald Roosevelt
Ruth Weir
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)
Dennis Manders, Secretary

Investment Advisory Committee

Robert W.P. Morse, Chairman
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Robert E. Hitchins
Archibald Roosevelt
William G. Wilson
Chester Rude, Adviser
Dennis Manders, Secretary

Retirement Committee

Robert W.P. Morse, Chairman
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
John L. Norris, M.D.
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Archibald Roosevelt
Wilbur Smith, C.P.A. (ex officio)
Robert E. Hitchins, Secretary

LITERATURE

Austin MacCormick, Chairman
Joel Bennett
Rollie Davidson
Barry Leach
Robert E. Hitchins
Jack Morley
Stephen Owen, Sr.
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Katharine Prince
Joseph Warren
Janet Graves, Consultant
Ann Macfarlane, Secretary

POLICY

Tom Breen, Chairman
Andy Anderson
Eric Bergman
Travis Dancy, M.D.
Rollie Davidson
Don Farrell
Robert E. Hitchins
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Katharine Prince
Hazel Rice
Frank Russell
Maurice Reilly, Jr.
Prof. Harrison Trice
Ruth Weir
Waneta New, Secretary

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Bayard Pope, Jr., Chairman
Paula Carpenter
Jim Cassidy
Janet Graves
John Henderson
Robert E. Hitchins
Rex Moody
Walter Murphy
Tom Rosenberg
Niles Peebles, Consultant
Cora Louise Belford, Secretary

NOMINATING

Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.,
Chairman
Frank Russell, Co-Chairman
Andy Anderson
Tom Breen
Travis Dancy, M.D.
Rollie Davidson
Robert E. Hitchins
Austin MacCormick
Charles Milton
Niles Peebles
Beth Kuhlmann, Secretary

INTERNATIONAL

Niles Peebles, Chairman
Joseph Besch
Paula Carpenter
Norman Crowley
Vincent Dole, M.D.
Adrian Frylink
Robert E. Hitchins

William Plunkert
Bayard Pope, Jr.
Jean Reed
Helen Traver
Mary Ellen Uribe
Stephen Finch
Midge McFadden, Secretary

1969 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA	(19) Ted Cooper, 128 Red Oak Road Birmingham, Alabama 35206
ALASKA	(18) *Willard C. Nelson, 3-A-5 Fair- view Manor, Fairbanks, Alaska 99701
ARIZONA	(18) Charles Douglas, 11814 N. 36th Place, Phoenix, Arizona 85028
ARKANSAS	(19) Neal Lancaster, P.O. Box 52, Siloam Springs, Arizona 72761
CALIFORNIA	(19) Southern - Art F. Kolkmann, Jr., 1432 Westmoreland Ave., Los Angeles, Calif. 90006 (19) Northern Coastal - Ed Brown, 1929 Hershner Drive, San Jose, Calif. 95124 (18) *Northern Interior - Ralph Wagy, 2459 San Jose Way, Sacramento, Calif. 95817 (18) San Diego - Bill Blake, P.O. Box 719, Oceanside, Calif. 92054 (18) Southern Coastal-Warren Snider, 671 Bay View, Laguna Beach, Calif. 92651
COLORADO	(19) Evelyn Bottom, 885 So. Ogden St., Denver, Colorado 80209
CONNECTICUT	(19) Charles Mitchell, 135 Alston Ave., New Haven, Conn. 06515
DELAWARE	(18) Margie Nicholson, 31 South Brad- ford St., Dover, Delaware 19901
D.C.	(19) Alex Blair, 1900 South Eads St., Arlington, Va. 22202 - Apt. 1029
FLORIDA	(19) Northern - Earl K. Martin, P.O. Box 996, Merritt Island, Florida 32952 (19) Southern - Fred Stevenson, 4411 No. Federal Highway, Pompano Beach, Florida 33064
GEORGIA	(18) Joe L. Clements, P.O. Box 39, Vidalia, Georgia 30474
HAWAII	(19) Frances Roberts, 1019 Lunaai Place, Kailua, Hawaii 96734
IDAHO	(18) Gordon Lucky, 2911 Annett, Boise, Idaho 83705
ILLINOIS	(19) Chicago - Bill Williams, 4713 Langley Ave., Chicago, Ill. 60615 (18) Northern - Joe Farley, 610 West 2nd Street, Dixon, Ill. 61021

What Do Panel Numbers Mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. This 19th Conference is made up of Panel 18 -- the old delegates -- and Panel 19 -- the new delegates.

STATE	PANEL
	(19) Southern - Dick Lewis, 69 Town & Country Dr., Decatur, Ill. 62526
INDIANA	(19) Northern - Joe Hochderffer, 1530 Crescent Ave., Fort Wayne, Ind. 46805 (18) Southern - Toy Ely, 740 S. Roosevelt, Orleans, Ind. 47452
IOWA	(19) R.E. "Bob" Anderson, Linn Grove, Iowa 51033
KANSAS	(18) William P. Lowe, 721 Freemont, Manhattan, Kansas 66502
KENTUCKY	(18) Frank Reynolds, Rt. #1, Glen- dale, Kentucky 42740
LOUISIANA	(19) Mabel Plyler, P.O. Box 233, Zachary, Louisiana 70791
MAINE	(18) Jim Knox, 9 Summer St., Presque Isle, Maine 04769
MARYLAND	(18) Ben J. Vincent, 19 Bayside Rd., Baltimore, Maryland 21222
MASSACHUSETTS	(19) Eastern - Junior Anderson, 31 LaSalle Rd., Needham Heights, Mass. 02192 (18) Western - Wilfred (Micky) Mc- Mahon, Granville Rd., Southwick, Mass. 01077
MICHIGAN	(19) Central - Charles Darien, 4406 Crissman, Flint, Mich. 48505 (19) Southeast - Joseph Calcaterra, 12235 Ewald Court, Sterling Heights, Mich. 48087 (18) Western - Don Walker, MR 65, South Haven, Mich. 49090
MINNESOTA	(18) Northern - Dave Harvey, 5702 Oneida, Duluth, Minn. 55804 (19) Southern - Marvin L. Jensen, 1306 Lucia Street, Fairmont, Minnesota 56031
MISSISSIPPI	(18) Malvin J. Pogue, Box 1397, Laurel, Mississippi 38335

DELEGATES (cont'd)

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
MISSOURI	(19) Eastern - Zora Hynes, 2430 Castle Drive, St. Louis, Mo. 63136	OREGON	(18) Ralph O. Lidman, 203 N. E. Steiger, Grants Pass, Ore. 97526
	(19) Western - Paul Simons, 2928 Mason, Independence, Mo. 64250	PENNSYLVANIA	(19) Eastern - Monroe Brubaker, 703 Smith Ave., Lebanon, Pa. 17042
MONTANA	(18) Joseph Boyd, Ashland, Mont. 59003		(19) Western - Henry Carr, 421 Gettysburg Ave., Pittsburgh, Pa. 15206
NEBRASKA	(18) James Griffin, P.O. Box 605, No. Platte, Neb. 69101	RHODE ISLAND	(18) Ruth Laidlaw, Bay State Road, Rehobeth, Ma. 02769
NEVADA	(19) Bob Rodgers, 2440 E. 9th Street, Reno, Nevada 89502	SOUTH CAROLINA	(18) *W.J. (Bill) Coleman, Box 518, Aiken, S.C. 29801
NEW HAMPSHIRE	(18) Neil Graves, Box 63, Portsmouth, New Hampshire 03801	SOUTH DAKOTA	(18) John Barkley, 524 N. Main, Aberdeen, S.D. 57401
NEW JERSEY	(19) Northern - Edmund Koeck, 10 Rosewood Drive, Madison, N.J. 07940	TENNESSEE	(18) Tom Moore, 121 So. 1st St., Pulaski, Tenn. 38478
	(18) Southern - Aaron Klotz, 192 So. Broad Street, Trenton, N.J. 08608	TEXAS	(19) Northeast - Kenneth Jordan, 211 Dorothy Dr., Richardson, Tex. 75080
NEW MEXICO	(18) Bob Hills, P.O. Box 3461, Albuquerque, N.M. 87110		(18) Northwest - George Guy, 3407 55th St., Lubbock, Tex. 79413
NEW YORK	(19) Central - Ada Ware, 1544 Dewey Ave., Rochester, N.Y. 14615		(19) Southeast - Ina Lee Copeland, 8150 Gulf Freeway, Houston, Tex. 77017
	(18) Hudson / Mohawk / Berkshire - Chuck Danahy, 44 Coleman Ave., Hudson Falls, N.Y. 12839		(18) Southwest - Carl W. Hemmi, 103 W. Huisache, San Antonio, Tex. 78212
	(19) Southeastern - George Stumpp, 36 Irwin Street, Sayville, N.Y. 11782	UTAH	(19) Aurelia (Shorty) Batchelor, 469 16th St., Ogden Utah 84404
	(18) Western - Bud Stimson, 41 Faragut Ave., Tonawanda, N.Y. 14150	VERMONT	(18) Orlando Cullinan, Arlington, Vt. 05250
NORTH CAROLINA	(19) Wade Johnson, 5105 Bennington Rd., Greensboro, N.C. 27410	VIRGINIA	(19) Mac Blair, P.O. Box 1207, Staunton, Va. 24401
NORTH DAKOTA	(18) Harold Valinski, Rt. 2, Grand Forks, N.D. 58201	WASHINGTON	(19) Al A. Dube, 421 So. 35th Ave., Yakima, Wash. 98902
OHIO	(19) Central & Southeast - Marie Lucas, 498 Loraine Dr., Pickerington, Ohio 43147	WEST VIRGINIA	(19) C.K. "Con" Hearn, 204 Sycamore, Clarksburg, W.Va. 26301
	(19) Northeast - John Low, 702 S. Main St., No. Canton, O. 44720	WISCONSIN	(18) N. Wisconsin & Upper Michigan - Paul Wiersgalla, 222 Niagara St., Eau Claire, Wis. 54701
	(18) N.W. Ohio & S.E. Michigan - George Moore, 3557 Beechway Blvd., Toledo Ohio 43614		(19) Southern - Martin L Toohey, 701 Long Court St., Sparta, Wis. 54656
	(18) South/Southwest Ohio & Northern Kentucky - Bob Frohmeyer, 1818 Lawn Ave., Cincinnati, O. 45237	WYOMING	(18) *Sam Leckie, Box 592, Rock Springs, Wyoming 82901
OKLAHOMA	(19) Bob Broach, 3913 East 40th, Tulsa, Oklahoma 74135	PUERTO RICO	(18) Manuel Rodriguez, Calle 22, Bloque 47, #18, Urb. Santa Rosa, Bayamon, P.R.

ROSTER

DELEGATES (cont'd)

PROVINCE	PANEL	PROVINCE	PANEL
CANADA			
ALBERTA	(18) Ken Kyle, 5709 110th St., Edmonton, Alberta, Can.		(19) Northwestern – Carl LeBlanc, Box 216, Schreiber, Ontario, Can.
BRITISH COLUMBIA/ YUKON	(19) Pat O'Hara, 7035 Arcola St. #106, Burnaby, B.C., Can.		(18) Western – Wyn Donohue, 100 Bay St. So., Hamilton, Ontario, Can. Apt. 507
MANITOBA	(18) Tom Grafton, 213 Notre Dame Ave., Winnipeg, Manitoba, Can. Apt. 304	QUEBEC	(18) Southwest (English) – Anthony (Tony) Gahan, 187 Quinn Blvd., Longueuil, Quebec, Canada
NEW BRUNSWICK/ PRINCE EDWARD ISL.	(18) Bill Gallant, Miscouche, Prince Edward Island, Can.		(18) Southwest (French) – Fernand Ippersiel, 229 Bishop – Power #102, Montreal, Que., Can.
NOVA SCOTIA/NEW- FOUNDLAND/ LABRADOR	(19) *Gordon Fulton, 41 Prescott Dr., Westphal, Halifax County, N.S.		(19) Northeast Quebec – Earl Paquette, 611 Rue Orstedt Arvida, Que., Can.
ONTARIO	(19) Eastern – Ed Allen, R.R. #1, Reaboro, Ontario, Can.	SASKATCHEWAN	(18) Jack Cennon, 608 20th St., West, Prince Albert, Saskatchewan, Canada
	(19) Northeastern – Maurice Lamothe, 25 Centre St., Sault Ste. Marie, Canada		

**Alternate Delegate*

1969 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

Agenda-Admissions

Orlando Cullinan, Vt.
James Griffin, Nebr.
Fernand Ippersiel, S.W. Que., Can.
Bill Lowe, Kan.
Tom Moore, Tenn.
Don Walker, W. Mich.

****Art Kolkmann, So. Calif.**
Dick Lewis, So. Ill.
Pat O'Hara, B.C./Yukon
George Stumpp, S.E.N.Y.

Ex Officio
Rose Behrhorst, Penn.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann

Conference Report & Charter

Joe Clements, Ga.
Chuck Danahy, H/M/B., N.Y.
Ken Kyle, Alta., Can.
Gordon Lucky, Ida.

Aurelia Batchelor, Utah
Marvin Jensen, So. Minn.
****Carl LeBlanc, N.W. Ont., Can.**
Earl K. Martin, No. Fla.
Charles Mitchell, Conn.
Frances Roberts, Hawaii

Secretary: Nell Wing

Finance

Wyn Donohue, W. Ont., Can.
Bob Frohmeyer, S.W. Ohio & No. Ky.
Tom Grafton, Man., Can.
Carl Hemmi, S.W. Tex.
Paul Wiersgalla, N. Wis. & Upper Mich.

Bob Anderson, Iowa
Joe Calcaterra, S.E. Mich.
Maurice Lamothe, N.E. Ont.
****Neal Lancaster, Ark.**
Fred Stevenson, So. Fla.

Ex Officio
Anthony Wysor
Robert McCullough

Secretary: Dennis Manders

Grapevine

Joe Farley, N. Ill.
Bill Gallant, N.B./P.E.I., Can.
Ralph Lidman, Ore.
Margie Nicholson, Del.
Manuel Rodriguez, P.R.

Ed Brown, No. Coastal Calif.
Henry Carr, W. Penn.
****Charles Darien, C. Mich.**
***Gordon Fulton, N.S./Nfld./Lab. Can.**
Paul Simons, W. Mo.

Ex Officio
Woody Ward, Okla.

Secretary: Paula Carpenter

Institutions

Joseph Boyd, Montana
Jack Cennon, Sask., Can.
Bob Hills, N.M.
Ruth Laidlaw, R.I.
Ben Vincent, Md.

****Alex Blair, D.C.**
Ted Cooper, Ala./N.E. Fla.
Ken Jordan, N.E. Texas
Bob Rodgers, Nev.
Bill Williams, Chicago

Ex Officio
Ralph Bruksos, Wash.

Secretary: Ann Mcfarlane
Acting Secretary: Mary Ellen Uribe

Literature

Charles Douglas, Ariz.
Toy Ely, So. Ind.
Tony Gahan, Que., Canada
Neil Graves, N.H.
Malvin Pogue, Miss.

Mac Blair, Va.
Evelyn Bottom, Colo.
****Al Dube, Wash.**
Martin Toohey, So. Wis.

Ex Officio
Pete Sumsion, Utah
Ray Gunther, Colo.
Andy Piippo, S.E. Mich.
Louis Rhodes, E. Penn.

Secretary: Ann Macfarlane

Public Information

Mickey McMahon, W. Mass.
Frank Reynolds, Ky.
***Sam Leckie, Wyo.**
***Ralph Wag, No. Int. Cal.**
Jim Knox, Me.

****Junior Anderson, E. Mass.**
Monroe Brubaker, E. Penn.
Wade Johnson, N.C.
John Low, N.E. Ohio
Ada Ware, Central, N.Y.

Ex Officio
Max Hall, Ark.
Verne Sorrells, W. Missouri

Secretary: Cora Louise Belford

Conference Policy

Bill Blake, San Diego, Calif.
George Guy, N.W. Tex.
***Willard Nelson, Alaska**
Aaron Klotz, So. N.J.
***Billy Coleman, S.C.**
George Moore, N.W. Ohio

Bob Broach, Okla.
Ed Koeck, N. N.J.
****Marie Lucas, C. & S.E. Ohio**
Mabel Plyler, La.

Ex Officio
Steve Purtell, Central N.Y.
Pat Sims, No. Coastal Calif.

Secretary: Waneta New

Conference Committee on Trustees

John Barkley, S.D.
Dave Harvey, No. Minn.
Warren Snider, So. Coastal Calif.
Bud Stimson, Western N.Y.
Harold Valinski, N.D.

Ed Allen, E. Ontario, Can.
Ina Lee Copeland, S.E. Texas
C.K. "Con" Hearn, W. Va.
****Joe Hochderffer, N. Ind.**
Zora Hynes, E. Mo.

Ex Officio
Sam Morningstar, W. Va.
Tom Mitchell, S.E.N.Y.

Secretary: Beth Kuhlmann
Acting Secretary: Midge McFadden

1970 CONVENTION COMMITTEE

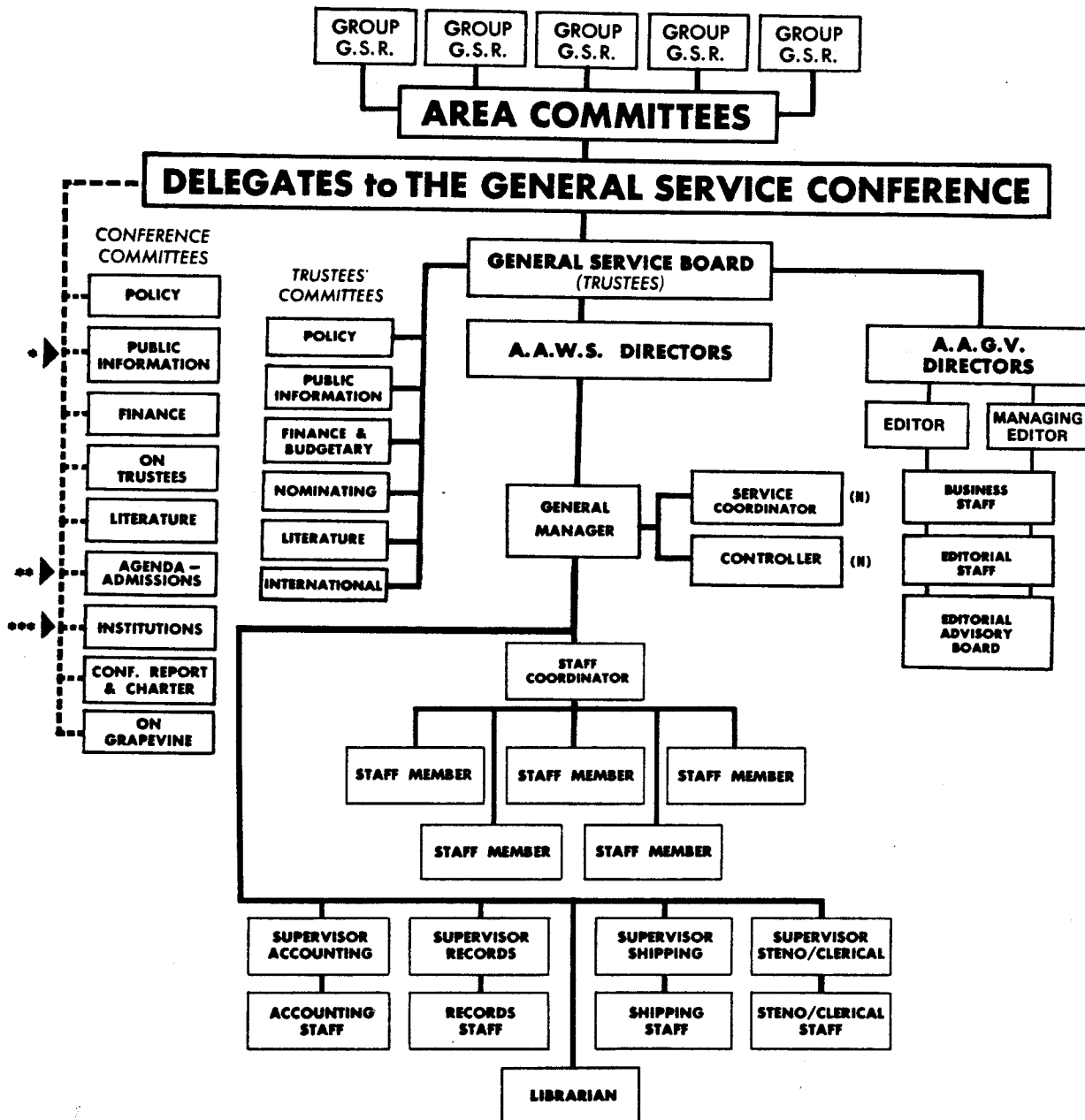
Neal Lancaster, Ark.
John Low, N.E. Ohio
Pat O'Hara, B.C./Yukon, Can.
Frances Roberts, Hawaii

Junior Anderson, E. Mass.
C.K. "Con" Hearn, W. Va.
Marvin Jensen, So. Minn.
Maurice Lamothe, N.E. Ont., Can.

Secretary: Hazel Rice

**Alternate Delegate*
***Chairman*

STRUCTURE OF THE FELLOWSHIP



• NAME CHANGED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

** COMBINED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

(N) ESTABLISHED BY A.A.W.S. IN 1966

*** CREATED BY 1966 CONFERENCE

	'63	'64	'65	'66	'67	'68	'69	'70	'71	'72	'73	'74	'75	'76	'77	'78	'79	'80	'81
EASTERN CANADA	4 years				4 years			4 years	3 years				4 years			4 years			
WESTERN CANADA				4 years			3 years				4 years				4 years			4 years	
NORTH EAST				4 years			3 years				3 years				4 years			4 years	
SOUTH EAST	4 years				4 years				3 years			3 years				4 years			4 yrs
SOUTH WEST	2 years				4 years				4 years						4 years			4 years	
EAST CENTRAL		4 years				4 years			3 years			3 years				4 years			4 yrs
WEST CENTRAL			*3 years			4 years			4 years			4 years				4 years			4 years
PACIFIC		4 years				4 years			3 years				4 years					4 years	

The above adjustments make it possible, starting with the 1975 elections, for two regional trustees to be elected each year. From that year on, all regional trustees will have full four-year terms.

ADJUSTMENT OF
TERMS

FOR REGIONAL TRUSTEES